

Microsoft Q&A user documentation

Get answers to frequently asked questions, troubleshoot common issues, and discover features related to Microsoft Q&A.

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Welcome to Microsoft Q&A

Article • 10/06/2023

We're delighted to have you join us as on Microsoft Q&A, the official platform for technical questions and answers about Microsoft products and services.

You have the opportunity to ask questions. You can also showcase your expertise, increase your reputation, and collaborate with other professionals in the Microsoft community. Our goal at Q&A is to help user at any stage of their skilling journey.

Getting started

To help you get started, here are some key resources for you:

- [Microsoft Q&A user documentation](#): This collection of documents provides you with some tips and recommendations on how to answer questions effectively, engage with users, and understand our community guidelines, code of conduct and similar policies on Q&A.
- [Manage your Microsoft Learn profile settings](#): This guide walks you through the steps to set up your profile, update your display name, public profile URL, manage email preferences, profile privacy settings, and other [preferences](#). A Learn profile is necessary to begin answering questions on Microsoft Q&A.
- [Moderation on Microsoft Q&A](#): This page gives you information about moderator activities on Q&A. Moderator permissions are granted based on Microsoft community managers or support teams requests. If you feel you should be a moderator, contact them directly.

Sharing feedback and bugs

Fresh eyes on the Q&A platform often open new insights on how to possibly update and improve on the current platform. Your feedback is important to the Q&A team. Provide feedback via the [Q&A tag](#).

Thank you!

Three key areas of feedback your can provide include:

- Suggestions: Use to suggest adjustments/improvements to existing features and workflows.
- Bugs: Use when site features aren't working as expected.

- Feature requests: Use to propose new functionality that you'd like to see on Microsoft Q&A.

We're excited to have you on board, and we look forward to seeing your team's contributions on Microsoft Q&A.

Thank you for your contributions to Microsoft Q&A.

Microsoft Q&A Code of Conduct

Article • 05/08/2025

This Code of Conduct applies to all users and content in Microsoft Q&A. It outlines expectations for participation on this site.

Microsoft Q&A is a global, community-driven platform for timely, high-quality technical answers. Communities thrive through diversity of thought and the safety of their members. Microsoft has a deep-seated commitment to diversity and inclusion. Therefore, we are committed to providing a welcoming and inspiring community for all. People violating this Code of Conduct may be suspended from Microsoft Q&A and get their account removed.

This Code of Conduct is not exhaustive or complete. It serves to capture our common understanding of a productive, collaborative environment. Where any aspect of this Code of Conduct conflicts with the [Microsoft Learn Terms of Use](#), the Microsoft Learn Terms of Use will take precedence.

Member Qualifications

The community is designed for individuals 13 years of age or older. We encourage parents to be aware of and help exercise control over content posted by and activities of their children to keep them safe online.

As a participant in this community, you agree that you will uphold this Code of Conduct and be responsible for all activities and content you upload and post. In addition to upholding this Code of Conduct, you're responsible for adhering to all applicable local and national laws.

This is your community. Help us to keep it safe, friendly, fun, and helpful.

When you're using Microsoft Q&A (the "Services") you will follow these rules.

Please do

- **Search before you post.** Search to see if a question you'd like answered has already been posted by somebody else. Posting the same question repeatedly and starting multiple threads on the same subject can be confusing. Someone will respond to your issue if they have the answer.
- **Be polite and respectful.** We are a worldwide community of professionals with different backgrounds, identities, and levels of expertise. Remember you might not be communicating in someone else's primary spoken language, and others may not have your level of understanding.

- **Respect the site's etiquette.** Use normal caps when you type. ALL CAPS typography is considered shouting and aggressive.
- **Learn from others.** We all make mistakes, and those should be seen as learning opportunities. If you post something that turns out to be incorrect and someone corrects you, thank the person instead of reacting negatively at the person who corrected you. We are all here to learn and to improve ourselves.
- **Keep conversation threads on track.** Stay on the topics of this site: technical questions and conversations on Microsoft technology. Don't divert or change a thread for your own purposes, start a new thread if necessary.
- **Be honest.** Cite the source of anything you post or upload, if it isn't your own original content.
- **Understand disagreements.** Disagreements, both social and technical, are useful learning opportunities. Seek to understand other viewpoints and resolve differences constructively.
- **Keep the community healthy.** Report any kind of abuse you find in the community. You can find a Report a concern option in every content.

Post to the right place. Is your question about Windows Client performance? Use the hierarchical tagging system to find the right tag. Selecting a hierarchical tag like `Windows Client for IT Pros > Performance > System performance` will help people understand what you're asking about. Moderators might update your tag to better route your question.

- **Mark correct answer as accepted.** This helps 'close' the thread. It also helps others know when searching for the right solution that the answer helped solve your problem.
- **Stay up to date.** Fine-tune your email notification preferences to receive updates about your questions in your profile settings.

Policies

To ensure the digital safety of how users interact with each other in their content and their conduct, Microsoft Q&A has rules about what types of content and conduct are not allowed. Prohibited content will be removed. Your account may be suspended or deleted from the Services if you post harmful content.

Bullying and harassment

We do not allow content or conduct that targets a person or group with abusive behavior. This includes any action that:

- Harasses, intimidates, or threatens others.
- Hurts people by insulting or belittling them.
- Continues contact or interaction that is unwelcome, especially where contact causes others to fear injury.

Child sexual exploitation and abuse (CSEA)

We do not allow the exploitation of, harm, or threat of harm to children on our site, CSEA is any content or activity that harms or threatens to harm a child through exploitation, trafficking, extortion, or endangerment. This includes sharing visual media that contain sexual content that involves or sexualizes a child. CSEA also includes grooming, which is the inappropriate interaction with children by contacting, private messaging, or talking with a child to ask for or offer sex or sexual content, sharing content that is sexually suggestive, and planning to meet with a child for sexual encounters. A child is anyone under 18 years old or who has not reached the age of majority under applicable law.

We will automatically delete the Microsoft account of any user posting CSEA.

Coordination of harm

Our site should never be used to hurt people, including by working with others to cause physical harm. Cooperating or making specific plans with others with the shared purpose of harming someone physically is not allowed.

Graphic violence and gore

Real-world violent content can be disturbing, offensive, or even traumatic for users. We also understand some violent or graphic images may be newsworthy or important for educational or research purposes, and we consider these factors when reviewing content and enforcing our policies. We do not permit any visual content that promotes real-world violence or human gore. This may include images or videos that show:

- Real acts of serious physical harm or death against a person or group.
- Violent domestic abuse against a real person or people.
- Severe effects or physical trauma, such as internal organs or tissues, burnt remains of a person, severed limbs, or beheading.

Hate speech and discrimination

We do not allow hateful content that attacks, insults, or degrades someone because of a protected trait, such as their race, ethnicity, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion,

national origin, age, disability status, or caste. Hate speech includes:

- Promoting harmful stereotypes about people because of a protected trait.
- Dehumanizing statements, such as comparing someone to an animal or other non-human, because of a protected trait.
- Encouraging or supporting violence against someone because of a protected trait.
- Calling for segregation, exclusion, or intimidation of people because of their protected trait.
- Symbols, logos, or other images that are recognized as communicating hatred or racial superiority.

Intimate imagery & intimate extortion

We do not allow content depicting nudity of any sort, including full or partial photographic human nudity, or nudity in cartoons, fantasy art or manga.

We do not allow NCII (non-consensual intimate imagery) to be distributed on our services, nor do we allow any content that praises, supports, or requests NCII. In general, if a video or image has the following traits, we treat it as NCII:

- It was taken privately, not in a professional setting.
- It shows sexual activity, nudity, or a sexualized body part.
- The person shown in the imagery didn't agree to either the creation or the sharing of the imagery.

Additionally, Microsoft does not allow any threats to share or publish NCII—also called intimate extortion. This includes asking for or threatening a person to get money, images, or other value things in exchange for not making the NCII public.

Sexual solicitation

We do not allow people to use its products and services to ask for or offer sex, sexual services, or sexual content in exchange for money or something else of value.

Suicide and self-injury

We work to remove any content about suicide and self-harm that could be dangerous. We also know that people may use our services to talk about mental health, share their stories, or join groups with others who have been affected by suicide or self-injury.

This includes the following (without limitation):

- Supporting general ways people can end their lives, such as with a gun, hanging, or drug overdose.
- Encouraging someone to take their life.
- Showing images of real or attempted suicide.
- Praising those who have died by suicide for taking their own life.

Self-injury content demonstrates, praises, or inspires physical harm to oneself, including through cutting, burning, or carving one's skin. It also includes content that encourages or instructs on eating disorders, or systematic over or under-eating.

Terrorism and violent extremism

We do not allow content that praises or supports terrorists or violent extremists, helps them to recruit, or encourages or enables their activities. We look to the United Nations Security Council's Consolidated List to identify terrorists or terrorist groups. Violent extremists include people who embrace an ideology of violence or violent hatred towards another group.

We will delete the Microsoft Learn account of any user posting terrorism and violent extremism content.

Trafficking

We do not allow any content that perpetrates human trafficking . Trafficking happens when someone exploits someone else for personal gain by depriving them of their human rights.

Trafficking commonly includes three parts:

- The act of recurring, moving, relocating, paying for, or abducting people.
- The use of—or threat of—force, lies, trickery, or coercion to do these activities.
- The activities are done for money, status, or some other kind of gain.

Trafficking includes forcing people to work, marry, engage in sexual activity, or have medical treatments or operations without their consent and is not limited to any age or background.

Violent threats, incitement, and glorification of violence

We do not permit content that encourages violence against other people through violent threats or incitement.

- Threats of violence are words that show a specific intention to cause someone serious physical harm.
- Incitement is material that encourages, urges, or is likely to result in serious physical harm to a person or group. We also do not allow the glorification of violence through content

that praises or supports real acts of violence causing serious physical harm to people or groups, including violence that happened in the past.

Adult and sexual

We do not allow the use of the Services to generate or share inappropriate content or material (involving, for example, nudity, bestiality, pornography, offensive language, graphic violence, self-harm, or criminal activity).

Profanity and vulgarity

We do not allow swearing or any other dismissive language.

Spam

We do not allow spam or any posts that engage in phishing or the generation or distribution of malware.

- Spam is unwanted or unsolicited bulk email, postings, contact requests, SMS (text messages), instant messages, or similar electronic communications.
- Phishing is sending emails or other electronic communications to fraudulently or unlawfully induce recipients to reveal personal or sensitive information to gain access to accounts or records, exfiltration of documents or other sensitive information, payment and/or financial benefit.
- Malware includes any activity designed to cause technical harm, such as delivering malicious executables, organizing denial of service attacks, or managing command and control servers.
- 'Pyramid schemes,' 'affiliate marketing,' or unsolicited commercial advertisements of any kind, including advertising for money making schemes, discount cards, credit counseling, online surveys or online contests.

Defamation, impersonation, false information

We do not allow any activities that are fraudulent, false, or misleading (e.g., asking for money under false pretenses; impersonating a Microsoft employee, agent, manager, host, administrator, moderator, another user, MVP, or any other person through any means; defamation; manipulating the Services to increase play count; or affect rankings, ratings, or comments).

Off topic or irrelevant content

This site is to get answers to your technical questions on Microsoft technologies.

- Refrain from posting questions on technologies or products unrelated to Microsoft.
- Ensure that your content aligns with the intended format: questions should seek answers, not serve as articles, product updates, or personal posts.
- Use comments to gather and share information pertinent to questions and answers. Avoid engaging in extended discussions within the comment section.

Personal or sensitive user information

For your own safety, do not post any sensitive information, such as passwords, dates of birth, Social Security numbers, passport numbers, credit card information, or financial information.

Other Terms of Use or Code of Conduct violation

We do not allow the following:

- Anything illegal
- Circumvent any restrictions on access to or availability of the Services.
- Pirating Microsoft software or products, or offering pirated software or products for sale, including posting product keys.
- Specifically violating Microsoft licensing or terms, such as posting content or links that will install a 3rd party kernel or evade security measures built into the software.
- Infringe upon the rights of others (e.g., unauthorized sharing of copyrighted music or other copyrighted material, resale or other distribution of Bing maps, or photographs).
- Activities that violate the privacy of others (e.g., attempting to harvest, collect, store, or publish private or personally identifiable information, such as passwords, account information, credit card numbers, addresses, or other contact information).
- Activities that help others break these rules.
- 3rd party paid promotions, including commercial software, freeware, freemium, except for non-commercial open source.
- Links to websites that require payment to access information.
- Links to external sites that violate this Code of Conduct.
- Political or religious content is considered off topic and not appropriate for the Services.
- Promoting or otherwise facilitating the purchase and sale of ammunition or firearms.

Non-authentic use of the Services

Don't engage in activities to circumvent any restrictions on access, availability to the Services, or misuse of the Services features including but not limited to:

- Use of fake accounts to vote, post questions and accept answers from members of the community to artificially earn reputation points.
- Creating alternative accounts when a primary account has been suspended from the Services to circumvent that suspension.
- Using features of the site, such as voting options, to penalize other users in retaliation for their actions on the Services.
- Using any form of automated device or computer program that enables the submission of postings without the express written consent of Microsoft Corporation.
- Plagiarizing the answers submitted previously by others and content from other websites as your own. Give proper sourcing and credit along with links to the original content source in your answers at all times. This includes adherence to the [Microsoft Q&A AI usage policy](#).

How we enforce these policies

We use a combination of automated technology and trained human reviewers to find and take action against any content or conduct that violates our terms and policies. We have systems and processes in place to make sure we are fair and consistent when enforcing these terms and policies. This helps us protect our users while also respecting their rights.

If you violate this Code of Conduct, we may stop providing Services to you or we may close your Microsoft account. We may also block delivery of communication (like email, file sharing or instant message) to or from the Services in an effort to enforce this Code of Conduct or we may remove or refuse to publish Your Content for any reason. When investigating alleged violations of this Code of Conduct, Microsoft reserves the right to review Your Content to resolve the issue. However, we cannot monitor the entire Service and make no attempt to do so.

User cautions

- Do not post sensitive data from your computer including memory dumps and/or configuration files. If you feel you need that to solve your problem, a Microsoft employee can start a private conversation with you to help you protect your data.
- Be very cautious about accepting direct help from another user. If that user suggests using Remote Assistance to help you, be aware that they will have access to your computer, and that your computer could be hacked.
- If you volunteer to help another user through Remote Access, be very careful not to harm their computer in any way, or to access information that is not openly made available to you. Abuse of Remote Access will not be tolerated and will result in a permanent ban from the Services.

- Please be careful with your personal information. If you post your email address in a thread, it may be used for any purpose by the general public, as this is a public community.
- Do not post information that could be used by others to steal your identity, like your street address, your phone number, your social security number, or your credit card number.
- Beware of scammers posting fake support numbers. Microsoft representatives have Microsoft Employee, Microsoft External Staff, or Independent Advisor affiliation displayed next to their names.

Termination and cancellation

Microsoft reserves the right, at its sole discretion, and without any obligation to do so, to review and remove user-created services and content at will and without notice and delete content and accounts. Microsoft reserves the right, at its sole discretion, to permanently ban participants or terminate access to the community.

Rights and Responsibilities

- We encourage you not to share information that others could use to harm you.
- Microsoft is not responsible for the content of any user-created posting, listing or message. The decision to view content or engage with others is yours. We advise you to use your best judgment.
- You are responsible for protecting your computer against interference, spyware or viruses that may be encountered. We recommend you install a virus protection program on your computer and keep it up to date.
- You may use the Report option in each thread to report violations of this Code of Conduct.
- Microsoft reserves the right to amend or change the Code of Conduct or any service at any time without notice. We encourage you to Follow this thread or periodically review these guidelines to ensure you're complying.
- Some information you provide or upload to the service may be stored outside of the country/region in which you reside.
- All activity on the service is also governed by the [Microsoft Learn Terms of Use](#) and the [Microsoft Privacy Policy](#).
- You acknowledge that you're a volunteer participant in The Services and that you may discontinue your participation at any time. Nothing related to your participation will be construed as creating an employer-employee relationship, a partnership, joint venture, association, or agency relationship, or as a limitation upon Microsoft's right to terminate

your access as foreseen above, or upon Microsoft's discretion, to terminate your access as provided herein. You assume all risk for your use.

- You understand that posting content or submitting material is voluntary, and you're under no obligation whatsoever to provide any submissions or contributions. You are solely responsible for your dealings with any third party that relates to your use of the community, or any information or materials you obtain from a third party.
- Microsoft shall not be obligated to provide, and you have no expectation of receiving, any compensation in any form for your voluntary participation in the community, or for your submissions or contributions.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) usage policy for Microsoft Q&A

Using Artificial Intelligence tools on Microsoft Q&A

AI tools have become widely accessible and increasingly popular, making it easier than ever for individuals to generate and consume information.

Many Microsoft Q&A contributors use these tools to help with the questions that are posted.

In November 2025, we launched [AI First Answers](#) for Microsoft Q&A. AI First Answer uses AI to help you get answers from Microsoft Learn documentation.

These tools are focused on assisting question authors, and there isn't an option to use these tools to help answering questions.

This document explains the policy for using AI tools to answer questions on Microsoft Q&A. It also describes how the platform moderators handle violations of these guidelines.

AI usage policy for Microsoft Q&A

Follow these steps when using AI to generate an answer on Q&A:

- Cite your sources: Mention the AI service name that generated the answer, fully or partly.
- Review before posting: All AI-generated content must be reviewed and validated. Unverified or hallucinated responses are not allowed and may be removed or lead to suspension. Community members are encouraged to report AI-generated responses that appear inaccurate or misleading.
- Share one solution at a time: The community is built around collaboration and step-by-step problem solving. Posting long lists of possible solutions at once does not support effective discussion. Additional solutions should be introduced gradually, based on user feedback and progress.
- Engage in the discussion: Responses should provide context, ask follow-up questions, and offer clear guidance. AI-generated content that lacks engagement or does not adapt to the discussion does not meet community standards.
- Avoid generic responses: Vague or surface-level AI input that adds no value beyond what a user could easily generate is not acceptable.
- Respect the community's purpose: Members come here seeking real expertise from real people, often after trying other tools, including AI. Misusing AI undermines trust and the quality of support across the community.

Using AI to help with answers on Microsoft Q&A requires following these steps. Otherwise, moderators might delete the content and suspend your account.

Moderator actions for AI-generated content on Microsoft Q&A

If a moderator finds AI-generated content on the platform that violates the requirements, they may take the following steps:

- Reply to the content with a comment including information the platform's AI policy.
- Delete the content that violates the policy, if the user doesn't respond to the notice or fails to make the necessary changes.
- Suspend the user's account, if the user repetitively fails to make the necessary changes.

Use of alternative accounts to circumvent a suspension, would be considered in violation of our [Code of Conduct for Microsoft Q&A](#).

Appeals process for deletions or suspensions due to AI usage on Microsoft Q&A

You can appeal the removal of your content from Q&A or the suspension of your account at this [email address](#).

Next steps

To ask anything about this policy, use the [Microsoft Q&A tag](#).

Last updated on 01/09/2026

Feedback on Microsoft Q&A

08/18/2025

We would love to hear your feedback on Microsoft Q&A. Your feedback is critical for us to understand how the site is performing and what we need to improve. Your feedback helps make Microsoft Q&A an even better platform. We evaluate feedback regularly and provide updates along the way.

ⓘ Note

This workflow only applies to feedback on the Microsoft Q&A platform. For other Microsoft products and services, please refer to their specific feedback channels off of the Microsoft Q&A site.

You can provide feedback on Microsoft Q&A on two areas: user experience or translations.

User experience feedback

This feedback is related to:

- **Issues** when site functionality isn't working as expected.
- **Suggestions** on adjustments or improvements to existing features and workflows.
- **Feature requests** are new functionality that you'd like to see on Microsoft Q&A.

Steps to provide user experience feedback

Follow these steps to provide user experience feedback about Microsoft Q&A.

1. Go to the [Community Center page](#) and/or use the site search feature to check if another user provided the same feedback. If they have, you can vote on that question instead of posting a new one.
2. Go to the Ask a Question page by selecting on the "Ask a question" button at the top right of any Q&A page.
3. Title: Enter the type of feedback (Issue, Suggestion, Feature request), followed by a brief and descriptive title to the feedback item you're submitting. *Example: "Suggestion: Increase the number of questions displayed per page."*
4. Tags: Tag all feedback with "Community Center/Discuss the Q&A site".
5. Details: Provide a thorough description of the feedback to help us understand and prioritize your submission as well as other users understand the feedback and vote on it.

Steps to vote on feedback

Use the content voting and rating functionality to engage with feedback submitting by other Microsoft Q&A users. We look at the number of votes as a data point to understand user priorities.

Translation feedback

If you see any text on the site not translated correctly, send an issue for our localization team by using [this form](#) [↗].

Q&A FAQ



Summarize this article for me

Frequently asked questions on Microsoft Q&A.

Getting started

What is Microsoft Q&A?

Microsoft Q&A is a Microsoft site where you can get fast access to questions about Microsoft technologies with Q&A, a global, community-driven platform for timely, high-quality technical answers.

What are the major benefits of Microsoft Q&A versus Stack Overflow?

We love Stack Overflow. We will continue supporting our customers who ask questions there. We also surface answers from Stack Overflow on Microsoft Q&A.

Stack Overflow has specific criteria about what questions are appropriate for the community whereas Microsoft Q&A has an open policy regarding this, where all questions about Microsoft technologies are welcomed. More importantly, via Microsoft Q&A we can create unique experiences that allow us to provide the highest level of support for our customers. It's hard to get a full picture of the customer who is asking a question on Stack Overflow. However, on Microsoft Q&A we can connect the asker to their actual product usage and support contract. This enables new opportunities to offer the highest quality support.

What is the difference between Microsoft Q&A and Microsoft Tech Community?

Microsoft Q&A is first party experience for technical answers on Microsoft products. Developers and IT pros can solve problems with the help of community experts and Microsoft engineering. The experience includes a rich knowledge base which ingests content from MSDN Forums and Stack Overflow to help customers get the answers they need quickly.

Microsoft Tech Community provides a connection between customers, Microsoft and community experts to share best practice and ideas, receive supportive encouragement and learn through discussions and blogs across Azure and Microsoft 365 products and programs.

How do I report a new feature or a bug for Microsoft Q&A?

You can provide us feedback by using the [Microsoft Q&A tag](#).

Where can I report offensive content?

Select the *Report* option next to the content you would like to report. From the drop-down box, select the reason for the offensive post. See more details in the [report content](#) article.

A moderator will review this report and act on it.

Is Microsoft Q&A mobile-friendly?

The site is accessible and usable on mobile devices.

What languages are supported on Microsoft Q&A?

Microsoft Q&A supports: Arabic (ar-sa), Chinese (Simplified) (zh-cn), Chinese (Traditional) (zh-tw), Czech (cs-cz), Danish (da-dk), Dutch (nl-nl), English (en-us), Finnish (fi-fi), French (fr-fr), German (de-de), Greek (el-gr), Hebrew (he-il), Hungarian (hu-hu), Italian (it-it), Japanese (ja-jp), Korean (ko-kr), Norwegian (nb-no), Polish (pl-pl), Portuguese - Brazil (pt-br), Russian (ru-ru), Spanish (es-es), Swedish (sv-se), Thai (th-th), Turkish (tr-tr).

How do I create an account?

If you have an account through Microsoft Learn, you can use the same account information here. If not, in the top right corner of the Q&A site you will see an option to sign in, which takes you to the process to create a new account. For more information, visit [Managing your Microsoft Learn profile](#).

How do I sign in?

In the Microsoft Q&A header, select **Sign in**. You can use the same user profile that you use on Microsoft Learn.

Can other users see my email address?

No. Take a look at another user's profile and you'll notice that an email address is not listed. The same goes for users who look at your user profile.

Why do I have to navigate to different pages to find the content that I am looking for instead of having infinite scrolling?

Infinite scrolling is not suitable for this type of content. It presents several issues, including:

- Difficulty in re-finding content
- Illusion of completeness
- Inability to access the end of the page
- Accessibility problems (users have to tab forever)
- Increased page load
- Poor SEO performance

Asking and answering questions

How do I ask a question?

In the Microsoft Q&A header, select the *Ask a question* button. As you type in your question, we will show you similar questions that have already been asked on Q&A and other sources. Make sure to check these because someone may have already answered your question.

You can find more details on best practices when asking questions in the [How to write a quality question](#) article.

How do I know if an answer is correct?

If the asker accepts an answer as correct, it will be shaded green and marked "Accepted Answer". If not, look for answers that have helpful votes, this means users have found those answers helpful. Learn more in the [rate answers](#) article.

How do I know if a user is knowledgeable?

If a user participates in and contributes positively to the community frequently, they will win points. The more reputation points a user has, the more likely they're to have expertise on the topic they're posting.

We also show Microsoft affiliations in the user's cards: Microsoft Employee, Microsoft External Staff, Microsoft Intern, Microsoft Agency Temporary, [Microsoft Most Valuable Professionals \(MVPs\)](#) [↗](#), Independent Advisor, Microsoft Regional Director, and Student Ambassador, so you know if the answer comes from a Microsoft-trusted source.

How can I sort all the questions?

At the top right of the questions page, you can see a *Sort by* drop-down menu. Select the option you would like to sort the content by. You can also filter out the content based on different criteria. Check our [filter and sort](#) article for details.

How do I answer a question?

Once you find a question you want to answer, you can write your reply at the bottom of the question's page. If the asker thinks the answer is correct, your response will be highlighted in green and marked as "Accepted Answer".

For more information on best practices while answering questions, see the [Writing a quality answer](#) article.

Who can answer a question?

Anyone signed in user can help others by answering a question on Microsoft Q&A. If you know the answer to a question, support the online community by answering it!

Can I vote my own content?

You can't vote your own questions, comments, or answers.

Can I vote on a question, answer, or comment more than once?

No, you can only vote once. You can change or cancel your vote if you change your mind.

What are tags?

Tags are topics related to your thread that help group and organize all the content on Microsoft Q&A. You can add tags to any kind of post by searching from a wide range of topics in the question that you're creating.

Do I have to add tags to a new question?

Yes, a minimum of 1 tag is required for each question. This helps the experts on that tag to monitor and answer your questions. The more tags you add the more information the community receives, making it easier to find similar questions and answer them.

How do I follow a tag?

Following a tag allows you to get alerts on the tag related to a particular service. To follow a tag, select *Tags* on the header, and hover the tag you want to follow. Select the *Follow* button. You can also follow tags from other pages by hovering on the tag and selecting on the *Follow* button.

If you want to receive notifications when a question is posted on the tags you follow, select your Avatar, and then *Settings*. Make sure you have an email for notifications. Then, on *Q&A preferences* section, select *Receive email when a question is posted on a tag you follow* and *Follow questions with tags you're following* and select *Save*. You can find more details in the [Q&A preferences](#) article.

Can I create a new tag?

Users can't create new tags at this moment.

AI Transparency

Are images that users upload scanned using AI?

Images that users upload as part of a post may be automatically scanned using AI to help detect harmful or non-compliant content. This scanning supports enforcement of community standards and helps promote a safe experience across the service. The AI analyzes visual content, and where applicable, text embedded in images.

User profile

What are reputation points?

Reputation points are earned by participating in and contributing positively to the community. For more information on reputation points, see the [reputation points](#) help article.

How do I earn reputation points?

There are many ways to earn reputation points, including answering questions, voting on answers, and more. To learn about all the ways you can earn (and lose) reputation points, see the [reputation points](#) help article.

How can I manage my settings?

In the Microsoft Q&A header, select your avatar in the top right, then select *Settings*. This will take you to your profile page where you can provide a notification email address as well as your Microsoft Learn and Q&A settings. You can find more details on the [Q&A preferences](#) article.

How do I update my profile?

In the Microsoft Q&A header, select your avatar in the top right and then select *Profile*. Here you will see options to update the different parts of your profile.

How can I subscribe/unsubscribe to get email notifications on different kinds of threads?

In the Microsoft Q&A header, select your avatar on the top right, and then select *Settings*. Under *Q&A preferences* you can choose what kinds of threads on Microsoft Q&A you get notified about and how often. You can find more details on the [Q&A preferences](#) article.

How can I see all the questions I save in a collection?

Select your avatar in the top right of the Microsoft Q&A header and then select *Profile*. Select *Collections* on the left section.

How can I view the questions and answers I've interacted with?

Select your avatar in the top right of the Microsoft Q&A header and then select *Profile*. Under *Activity* you will see up to 30 interactions over the past 30 days..

Moderation

What can moderators do?

Moderators are a part of the Microsoft Q&A community to maintain high quality content. Moderators can delete/undelete content, ban users, redirect threads, close threads, and edit content to keep threads relevant and appropriate.

If a moderator's message gets flagged, can they cancel that report?

They can't, only another moderator will be able to.

Can moderators mark answers as "Accepted Answers"?

No, only the question author have those permissions.

Data storage

Where does Microsoft Q&A store customer data?

Microsoft Q&A doesn't move or store customer data out of the region it's deployed in.

Priority Community Support (PCS)

What is Priority Community Support (PCS)?

Priority Community Support (PCS) is the first line of support for customers with a [Developer Support Plan](#) . With PCS, customers receive high-quality answers to Azure-related questions on Microsoft Q&A within business hours from Azure engineers and Community Champions.

How do I access Priority Community Support?

Priority Community Support can be accessed from the Azure Portal under the "Create a support request" option in Support + Troubleshooting or by signing in to Microsoft Learn with the same account that has access to your Azure benefit subscription.

Change Microsoft Q&A preferences

Article • 06/26/2023

Your profile on Microsoft Q&A is the same on Microsoft Learn. As part of your Microsoft Learn profile, you can select what Microsoft Q&A to follow automatically on whether receiving mail notifications for certain content and when.

Prerequisites

- You need to have a Microsoft Learn profile.
- To receive email notifications from Q&A, you need to provide an email address for Microsoft Learn.

Limitations

None

Automatically follow Q&A content

Choose what questions you would like to automatically follow on Microsoft Q&A.

1. Go to your [profile settings page](#).
2. Go to the "Q&A preferences" section.
3. Under the "Q&A follow preferences", select or unselect the options that best work for you.
 - a. Follow questions you've asked
 - b. Follow questions you've answered
 - c. Follow questions you've commented on
 - d. Follow questions with tags you're following
4. Select "Save".

Provide your email address

If you have not done so already, provide an email address to receive notifications from Microsoft Learn. After that, you can select your Microsoft Q&A mail preferences.

1. Go to your [profile settings page](#).
2. Scroll down to the "Manage email preferences" section.

3. Provide the email address where you would like to receive notifications as well as your country/region of residence.
4. Select "Save".

Receive mail notifications from Q&A

Now that you have an email address on Microsoft Q&A, you can select your options to receive Q&A email notifications. By default, once you opt-in to receive mail notifications from Microsoft Learn, you opt in to get notifications from Q&A. You can change that by following [Stop email notifications from Q&A](#).

1. Go to your [profile settings page](#).
2. Scroll down to the "Q&A preferences" section.
3. If it's disabled, enable the "Q&A email notifications" option.
4. You will see different sections so you can update the mail preferences as needed.
5. Select the "Save" button once you're done setting your preferences.

Stop email notifications from Q&A

1. Go to your [profile settings page](#).
2. Scroll down to the "Q&A preferences" section.
3. Disable the "Q&A email notifications" option.

Q&A email notification preferences explained

Here is an explanation of the options within the "Q&A email preferences" section.

Q&A email notifications

This option enables or disable Q&A email notifications for you. When you disable this option, Microsoft Q&A saves your other preferences, so if you enable mail notifications again, you start right at your last selections. If you disable this option, you will still receive some mails from Microsoft Q&A such as

- You have been added or removed from a moderation group.
- Your content has been reported for a moderator to review.
- Your account has been suspended, or the suspension on your account has been lifted.

Mention email notifications

When you enable this option, you will get a mail whenever a user mentions you on Microsoft Q&A. A user mention is meant to bring your attention onto a question, such as letting you know they're answering your question, asking you to clarify your comment, etc.

Moderation email notifications

You only see this option if you're moderator on Microsoft Q&A. If you enable this option, you can get one mail each time content is reported to moderation on Q&A, so you can quickly act upon it.

Follow email notifications

You have the option to get notifications when someone follows you or when certain actions happen on questions you [manually follow on Q&A](#) or you set up to [automatically follow Q&A content](#).

Followers

You receive an email notification when someone follows you. You can get a notification right away, or have a daily digest of the last 10 people that follow you in the last day or the last 20 people that follow you the last week.

Questions

The options within the "Questions" subsection are based on questions you [manually](#) or [automatically](#) follow on Q&A. You can get a notification right away, or have a daily digest of the last 10 people that follow you in the last day or the last 20 people that follow you the last week. Available options are:

- Receive email when a question is posted on a tag you follow
- Receive email when a question you follow is edited
- Receive email when questions you follow do not have any answers

Answers

The options within the "Answers" subsection are based on questions you [manually](#) or [automatically](#) follow on Q&A. You can get a notification right away, or have a daily digest of the last 10 people that follow you in the last day or the last 20 people that follow you the last week. Available options are:

- Receive email when an answer is posted on a question you follow
- Receive email when an answer is edited on a question you follow
- Receive email when an answer is accepted on a question you follow

Comments

The option "Receive email when a comment is posted on a question you follow" within the "Comments" subsection applies to questions you [manually](#) or [automatically](#) follow on Q&A. You can get a notification right away, or have a daily digest of the last 10 people that follow you in the last day or the last 20 people that follow you the last week.

Microsoft Q&A moderators

Article • 01/12/2025

A Microsoft Q&A moderator assists with the day-to-day affairs of the community. The effectiveness of the moderation directly impacts the quality of the community in general, its usefulness as a Q&A site, and the customer satisfaction rate.

Moderators are also responsible for maintaining the integrity of the site. This includes ensuring that questions and answers are posted with the correct information, helping to protect customer privacy, and managing violations to the [Code of Conduct](#).

As product experts, Microsoft Q&A moderators assist customers by answering questions and helping customers to post better questions and answers. See [How to write a quality answer](#) for more information.

There are two type of moderators on Microsoft Q&A:

1. **Microsoft moderators**
2. **Volunteer moderators**

Both **Microsoft moderators** and **Volunteer moderators** take part in the task of helping to support the community by:

- Answering questions
- Helping others to ask [good questions](#) or [provide good answers](#)
- Ensure an inclusive community
- Ensure all users follow the [Microsoft Q&A code of conduct](#)

The main differences between Microsoft moderators and Volunteer moderators are:

- **Microsoft moderators** are Microsoft employees who are part of a support team or a product group. Most or part of their work is to answer questions or help the community.
- **Volunteer moderators** are active community members in Q&A who are making a positive impact. Some of these moderators are part of the [Community Champions Program](#).

How to become a Community Champion on Q&A

- [Microsoft Most Valuable Professionals \(MVPs\)](#) [↗](#).
- [MSDN and TechNet moderators who want to continue moderating in Q&A](#).

- Be a leader in the community and be nominated by a current moderator or a Microsoft employee.

Microsoft reserves the right to include other moderators in this program outside the requirements listed above.

Actions moderators can take on the site

For more information about what things moderators can do on Microsoft Q&A, see the following articles:

- [Editing content](#)
- [Mark a question as duplicate](#)
- [Convert an answer to a comment](#)
- [Convert a comment to an answer](#)
- [Answer questions about products no monitored Microsoft Q&A](#)
- [Delete content](#)
- [Suspend a user](#)
- [Start a private conversation](#)

Thank you for being a moderator on Microsoft Q&A!

Gain reputation points

 Summarize this article for me

As the name implies, *Reputation points* allow you to earn points based on quality contributions on Microsoft Q&A and use them as a way to show your reputation to other users.

Prerequisites

- You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).
- You need to take actions that can give you reputation points.

Limitations

- Not all actions on Microsoft Q&A grant points.
- You can lose reputation points.

How to gain reputation points

You can earn reputation by first participating and contributing positively to the community on Microsoft Q&A. Then, as others recognize your contribution (say by somebody accepting your answer as correct), you'll receive reputation points.

Below is a table that shows the activities we track in the recognition system and the points associated to those activities. There are many activities that award zero (0) points - those are listed to help you understand what we deem as quality contributions. Also note that not all activities in this list will appear in your profile activity feed; for instance negative actions are not listed publicly.

 Expand table

Activity	Points earned
You received an up vote to a question, answer, or comment	5
You accepted an answer on a question you posted	20
A user accepted your answer	75
Your content gets deleted	-10

FAQ

Q: Is there any limit on the amount of points I can earn?

A: Yes, we have established a daily limit of 500 points a user can earn over a 24-hour period.

Q: What happens to my reputation points if the content gets deleted?

A: If content gets deleted and you earned reputation points on it, you will also lose those reputation points.

Q: Can I have negative reputation points?

A: Yes.

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Microsoft Azure Q&A Champions Program

Overview



The **Microsoft Azure Q&A Champions Program** recognizes and empowers a global community of internal and external Azure experts who help customers succeed by providing **high-quality, trusted** answers on Microsoft Q&A. The program scales expert led community support for Azure by combining **human expertise with AI driven workflows**, enabling faster, more consistent, and more trustworthy answers at scale - while strengthening the overall Azure support ecosystem. As Microsoft Q&A evolves toward **AI-led answer experiences**, Q&A Champions play an increasingly critical role as **quality stewards, moderators, and AI governance partners**, ensuring that answers customers rely on remain accurate, safe, and authoritative.

[Azure Champions Leaderboard](#)

Sign up here: [Microsoft Q&A Champions Program – Azure](#) ↗

Why the Q&A Champions program matters

Azure customers ask tens of thousands of technical questions on Microsoft Q&A every year. Many of these questions can be resolved quickly and effectively through **community expertise**, when guided by the right quality standards and tooling.

The Q&A Champions Program helps Microsoft:

- Scale high quality Azure support beyond traditional 1:1 support models
- Improve **time-to-answer**, **answer quality**, and **customer trust**
- Preserve engineering and support capacity for complex, high severity scenarios
- Create a sustainable, expert moderated support model powered by AI and humans together

For Champions, the program offers a way to **amplify impact**, grow technical credibility, and shape how Azure knowledge is shared globally.

How the program works

Who Are Q&A Champions?

Q&A Champions are **trusted Azure experts**, including:

- Microsoft Most Valuable Professionals (MVPs)
- Microsoft engineers and subject matter experts
- Partners and external Azure specialists
- Highly active and high quality community contributors

Champions are selected based on **quality, consistency, and impact** - not just volume of answers.

What Champions do

Champions contribute across several evolving roles:

- **Answer Azure questions** with accurate, clear, and actionable guidance
- **Validate and improve AI-generated answers**, especially on high impact threads
- **Moderate and steward quality**, including tag hygiene and community standards
- **Provide feedback** that helps improve AI answer systems and workflows
- **Mentor new contributors** and help grow the expert community

As AI generated answers become more prevalent, the Champion role shifts from *“how many answers are written”* to *“how much trust, accuracy, and learning is enabled at scale.”*

Benefits of becoming a Q&A Champion

Becoming a Q&A Champion is a powerful learning by doing opportunity - you get hands on exposure to the latest, real customer problems, early signals on Azure friction points, and direct insight into how customers are using (and struggling with) our products today.

Champions receive a combination of **recognition, enablement, and growth opportunities**, including:

- **Public recognition** as a Microsoft Q&A Champion [Azure Champions Leaderboard](#)
- **Q&A Moderator privileges** (for eligible Champions), enabling trusted contributors to help steward quality, moderate content, and uphold community standards
- Support for **Microsoft MVP nominations and renewals** (where applicable)
- **Perspectives and visibility for Microsoft employees**, helping amplify technical impact and thought leadership beyond your immediate team
- **Rewards and incentives** based on impact and contribution quality
- **Opportunities to influence Azure documentation, tooling, and AI-assisted answer experiences**, shaping how Azure knowledge is delivered at scale
- **Invitations to Champion only calls, feedback sessions, and enablement forums**, with early visibility into platform and program updates
- **Increased visibility and credibility** within the Azure technical community

Note: Incentives and recognition evolve over time and are tied to quality and impact — not automated volume.

Quality First: What We Expect

The program emphasizes **quality over quantity**. Champions are expected to:

- Provide technically accurate, well reasoned answers
- Cite authoritative Microsoft documentation when appropriate
- Follow Microsoft Q&A community guidelines and AI usage policies
- Help maintain a high trust bar for Azure answers

This ensures customers can rely on Microsoft Q&A as a credible, first stop technical resource.

AI + Human Expertise: The Future of Q&A Champions

The Q&A Champions Program is a core part of Microsoft's **AI first, expert moderated support model**.

AI helps with:

- Faster initial answers
- Coverage across a broad range of Azure topics
- Surfacing patterns and gaps in community knowledge

Champions ensure:

- Accuracy and correctness
- Context, nuance, and real world experience
- Responsible use of AI in customer facing answers

Together, AI and Champions enable trusted answers on a global scale.

Who should join?

You may be a great fit if you:

- Have hands on experience with Azure services
- Enjoy helping others solve technical problems
- Care about answer quality, not just speed
- Want to build community credibility and impact
- Are interested in shaping the future of AI assisted support

Both Microsoft employees and external experts are welcome.

How to join the Microsoft Q&A Champions Program

To express interest and apply: Sign up here: [Microsoft Q&A Champions Program – Azure](#) 

Additional resources

- [Azure Champions Leaderboard](#)
 - [Microsoft Q&A](#)
 - [How to write a quality answer](#)
 - [Microsoft Q&A Code of Conduct](#)
-

Microsoft Q&A Product Champions Program

The **Microsoft Q&A Product Champions Program** recognizes technology experts who contribute to Microsoft Q&A product forums by providing high quality answers, sharing insights, and helping users troubleshoot real-world problems. This self-paced program includes everyday Microsoft Q&A participants, Microsoft fulltime employees, MVPs, suppliers, partners, students, independent experts, and Q&A moderators — all passionate about improving the Microsoft Q&A experience.

Learn more below and [sign up](#) to automatically join the program.

Program Structure

The program spans **six product tracks**, enabling experts to focus on their specialty areas:

- Microsoft 365
- Microsoft Teams
- Windows
- Surface
- Developer Technologies
- Security & Compliance

After signing up, members are automatically enrolled and their advancement through tier levels is determined by the number of questions they answer and the consistency of their contributions. Level badges appear directly on Microsoft Q&A profiles. Full progression paths are detailed in the [Welcome Guide](#) & [Tech Community Hub](#).

Incentives

- **Badges & Leaderboard:** Earn tiered badges and appear in monthly/yearly leaderboards.
- **Community Access:** Join our private [Tech Community](#) group and connect with other contributors.
- **Spotlights & Features:** Get social media recognition, newsletter highlights, and contributor story features.
- **Learning & Growth:** Receive certification discounts and opportunities to learn from top experts.
- **Leadership Opportunities:** Access guest speaker opportunities and paths toward becoming a [Volunteer Moderator](#).

- **MVP Support:** Eligible contributors receive [Microsoft Most Valuable Professionals \(MVPs\)](#) nomination and renewal support.
- **Champion Exclusives:** End of year swag and a dedicated Champion spotlight post.

Resources

- [Product Champions Program signup form](#)
- [Join our Tech Community Hub](#)
- [Questions?](#)

Privacy Notice

If you would like to be removed from the Microsoft Q&A Product Champions Program and have your personal data deleted, please email us at Productchampions@microsoft.com. This request must be sent from the email address you provided at registration. We will delete your personal data within seven (7) business days. This action is limited to the Microsoft Q&A Product Champions Program and will have no impact on other Microsoft applications. Please see the Microsoft Privacy Statement for information on broader privacy requests.

Microsoft Privacy Statement: <https://aka.ms/PrivacyStatement>

Last updated on 02/10/2026

Ask a question on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 02/19/2025

Microsoft Q&A allows users to ask and answer technical questions about Microsoft technologies. The following guide explains how to ask a question on Microsoft Q&A.

Prerequisites

You need to be signed in Q&A.

Tips

- We recommend you read the article [How to write a quality question](#) to create a better question that might get faster and more accurate answers.
- If you ask a question from a tag page, Q&A adds the tag automatically to your question.
- If you navigate away while entering your question, you can resume later as Q&A saves you a [draft](#).

Ask a question

Start asking a question by selecting the "Ask a question" button at the top right of any [Q&A page](#). Asking a question requires three parts:

1. A *title* that summarizes the problem.
2. A *tag* that categorizes your question with other, similar questions. Using the right tag makes it easier for others to find and answer the question.
3. A *body* where you add all the details of your question.

Title

Provide a *title* that summarizes your question, scenario, and the technologies involved. Including these details can enhance the likelihood of receiving a response.

Tag

Use the provided dropdowns to select a *tag* that best categorizes your question. The new tagging system uses a hierarchy to help route your question to the most appropriate experts. You can only select 1 hierarchical tag.

Tags *

Select tags from the dropdowns below.

Select a tag *

Windows



Select a child tag *

Windows Client for IT Pros



Body

Use the rich-web editor to enter the details of your question. To make your question effective, include the following information:

- **Service:** Mention the technologies involved in your scenario or the ones you intend to use, such as Azure WebApps, Python, code snippet, etc.
- **Scenario:** Describe your scenario and what you're trying to achieve by highlighting the **what and how** of your question.
- **Result:** Provide the outcome of your scenario, including error codes, stack traces, and controls.
- **Environment:** Specify any specific requirements, system information, operating system or application version, and network details related to your scenario.
- **Troubleshooting efforts:** Mention any documentation you have referred to and the steps you have taken to resolve the issue.
- **Supporting materials:** If possible, include a screenshot, video, code snippets, or logs to help other users understand your issue better.
- **Give reproducible steps:** If applicable, provide a clear outline of the steps required to reproduce the scenario, along with any relevant documentation. For programming-related questions, provide a minimal test case that demonstrates the issue. Share enough code to allow others to recreate the scenario and offer informed recommendations.

Avoid including:

- **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** Any posts found with PII will either be edited or deleted to protect that data.
- **Multiple questions in the same thread:** Create separate threads for each of your questions. This approach ensures that the community can focus on each topic and provide the best possible responses.
- **Images from the web:** Q&A blocks certain domains, which may result in images not being available. Use [attachments](#) instead.

Post your question

Once you're ready, select the "Post your question" button.

Q&A AI First Answer: Get answers faster with AI

10/27/2025

Q&A First Answer is a feature that provides:

- An AI-generated response within seconds after you post a question on Q&A without requiring you to press a button.
- A high-quality response to resolve your inquiry without requiring you to wait for the community, suppliers, or moderators to provide a response.

Note: AI responses are not a replacement for human expertise on Q&A. Community members can still provide responses below, ensuring a mix of perspectives address your query. Moderators also have full authority to recommend or remove the AI response, maintaining quality and trust.

Q&A First Answer Limitations

Q&A First Answer has the following limitations:

- **Language:** This feature only supports English locales, and AI-generated answers aren't provided to non-English posts.
- **Attachments:** Q&A First Answer does not support posts with attachments. Posts with attachments on Q&A will not receive an AI response. Attachment-support will be included in a future iteration of this feature.
- **One-Question Conversation:** This feature allows you to request a one-time regeneration of the AI response if you're unsatisfied with it. However, it doesn't support prompting the model with information as to what you're looking for in the improved response. This functionality would entail a multi-turn conversation, which isn't within the capacity of this feature's infrastructure.
- **AI-Generated Responses:** This feature's infrastructure aims to provide accurate information, but it may sometimes provide incomplete or unresponsive/irrelevant answers. If you encounter such content, please provide feedback to help us improve the feature.

How to Use Q&A First Answer

- When you post a question on Q&A, an AI-generated response appears within seconds, without requiring action from the user.
- The AI answer will be the first response posted but community members, moderators, and suppliers in some cases will still be able to provide human responses below the AI response.
- If you're satisfied with the response, please accept the answer at the bottom of the response. This feedback improves the visibility of high-quality content on the platform.
- If you're unsatisfied with the response, please proceed to reject the response, after which you'll be prompted to provide a reason for your dissatisfaction.
- You'll also be able to decide between entirely rejecting the response, which simply deletes it, or regenerating it. Regeneration is a one-time functionality that generates a new response, which you can proceed to accept or reject (delete).
- Moderators will be able to recommend or delete AI responses, while also monitoring user feedback.

Privacy

Read our [Microsoft Privacy Statement](#) to learn more about how to access and control your personal data.

We want to hear from you

- We want to know whether Q&A First Answer was helpful to you or not.
- If you receive unsatisfactory responses using the tool, please inform us by rejecting the response and providing a reason for your dissatisfaction.
- If you find this feature to be helpful, please let us know by accepting AI-generated responses that resolve your queries.
- We constantly review this feedback to adapt the model's prompt and improve the feature's performance. We aim to provide higher-quality responses and improve your experience on the platform.

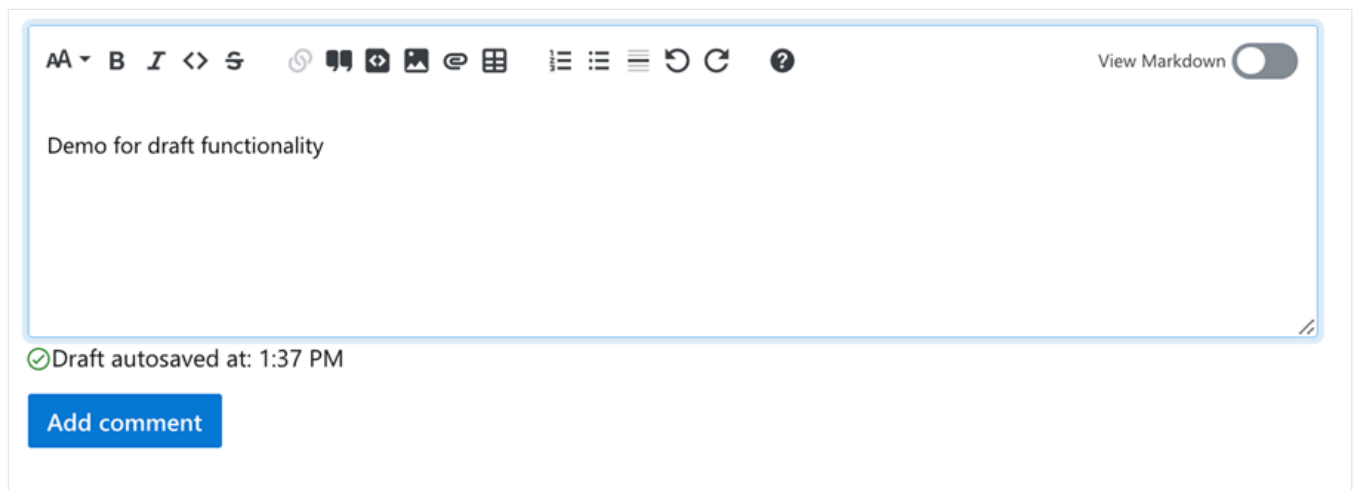
Drafts on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

Microsoft Q&A includes a draft functionality that saves your in-progress thread (question, answer, or comment) every few seconds, as you work. Drafts help reduce the risk of data loss and allow you to return to continue your post later.

Q&A automatically saves a draft as you enter content into the editor for questions, answers, and comments. Under the editor, a message appears confirming that you have a draft saved and when, as shown below.



Prerequisites

You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).

Limitations

1. Drafts for editing content is not available.
2. There is a limited number of drafts per user:
 - 1 per question
 - 1 answer per question
 - 1 comment per question
 - 1 comment per answer
3. Q&A clears drafts after 30 days after last save and you cannot recover them beyond this point.
4. You can remove a draft by
 - a. Deleting the content from the editor when accessing the draft;
 - b. Clearing browser storage; or

- c. By posting the content on Q&A.
- 5. There are not drafts for content while editing it.

Access your questions drafts

1. Go to the "Ask a question" page.
2. A modal will appear asking you to either open the saved draft or discard the draft and begin asking a new question.

Access your answer drafts

1. Go to the question thread where you created the answer draft. Your content will automatically populate in the editor when you return to any question thread with a saved draft.
2. To continue the draft, just keep adding your content in the editor as usual.

Next steps

None

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Guidelines for posting a quality question on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 02/19/2025

Microsoft Q&A enables users to ask and answer technical questions on Microsoft technologies. To get the best and quickest answers, it's important to ask well-crafted questions.

This article provides tips and recommendations for writing effective questions on Microsoft Q&A, to help you get faster answers from various experts, including [Microsoft Most Valuable Professionals \(MVPs\)](#) [↗](#), Microsoft product group owners, and other knowledgeable users. By following these guidelines, you can maximize your chances of getting the information you need from the Microsoft Q&A community.

- [Avoid duplicating questions](#)
- [The title is specific and summarizes your question](#)
- [Include information about the scenario and any supporting material like screenshots](#)
- [Ask one question per thread](#)
- [Use the right tag to increase visibility to the right experts](#)
- [Follow the Microsoft Q&A community guidelines](#)

Tip

This is a site for support, so please use the right site to requests new feature requests about a Microsoft product or report any bugs. This will ensure that the experts can focus on resolving your problems instead of having to redirect you to the right site.

Avoid duplicate questions

To make the best use of Microsoft Q&A, it's important to avoid asking questions that have already been answered. We make this very easy for you! When you post a question, Q&A will show you related questions from Q&A, MSDN & TechNet Forums, and Stack Overflow. This helps you in several ways:

1. By suggesting previously answered questions, you can quickly find a solution without having to ask a new question, saving you time.

2. If you find a relevant question, you can add your question to the existing thread by providing more details about your scenario or by voting to indicate that you have the same issue. This helps draw more attention to the question, increasing the chances of a faster solution from the community.

Write a title that summarizes your question

When experts are trying to answer as many questions as possible, they may quickly scan the titles of questions to identify those they're likely to know the answer to. Questions with titles like "Urgent! Help needed!" are less likely to get answered compared to questions with a specific, detailed title like "How do I use the BinaryFormatter with IIS?" A title that summarizes your scenario and the technologies involved increases the chances of getting a response.

A good title should include three components: Service, Scenario, and Result.

- **Service:** The service or technology you're using.
- **Scenario:** A brief description of the scenario or task you're trying to achieve.
- **Result:** The desired outcome, usually indicating an error or the need for guidance with a specific step.

Examples of good titles:

1. Azure Windows Virtual Machine: Unable to RDP due to authentication error
2. Azure WebApp: How do I upload and configure an existing SSL certificate
3. Azure IoT Hub: All requests to IoT Hub fail due to an error code 403002
IoTHubQuotaExceeded

Keep it clear and concise

To help experts to better understand your issue and provide a solution, it's important to post a clear and concise question. To make your question effective, include the following information:

- **Service:** Mention the technologies involved in your scenario or the ones you intend to use, such as Azure WebApps, Python, code snippet, etc.
- **Scenario:** Describe your scenario and what you're trying to achieve by highlighting the **what and how** of your question.
- **Result:** Provide the outcome of your scenario, including error codes, stack traces, and controls.
- **Environment:** Specify any specific requirements, system information, operating system or application version, and network details related to your scenario.

- **Troubleshooting efforts:** Mention any documentation you have referred to and the steps you have taken to resolve the issue.
- **Supporting materials:** If possible, include a screenshot, video, code snippets, or logs to help other users understand your issue better.
- **Give reproducible steps:** If applicable, provide a clear outline of the steps required to reproduce the scenario, along with any relevant documentation. For programming-related questions, provide a minimal test case that demonstrates the issue. Share enough code to allow others to recreate the scenario and offer informed recommendations.

Important

Ensure that you do not include Personally Identifiable Information (PII). This is a public site and any posts found with PII will either be edited or removed to protect that data.

Avoid posting multiple questions in a single thread

To ensure that you receive a clear and helpful answer to your questions, it's important to post them individually. When you have multiple questions, each with its own distinct scenario, it can make it more difficult for the community to understand the problem and provide an accurate solution. For this reason, we recommend that you create separate threads for each of your questions. This way, the community can give you their undivided attention and provide the best possible response.

Use the right tag for your question

Experts follow [tags](#) related to their expertise, so choosing the right tag will increase the likelihood of getting you a quicker response. Use Microsoft Q&A's hierarchical tagging system to help find the most relevant tag for your question.

Next steps

Once you receive a correct answer, mark it as "Accepted". This step is important, since it lets others know that the question has a verified answer. See more information in the [Accept answers](#) article.

Private messages on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 04/09/2024

Private messages on Q&A enable Microsoft moderators (support engineers employed by Microsoft,) to privately message question authors. The purpose of private messaging functionality is to allow Microsoft moderators to privately engage with question authors in scenarios where troubleshooting steps might contain PII (Personally identifiable information.) We never want users to post PII publicly on the platform, so private messages allow question authors and Microsoft moderators to exchange necessary information in a private, safe way!

Question authors – How to reply to a private message

From email notification

1. View email notification about new private message.
2. Click button to view and reply to private message.
3. Question thread with private messages modal opens on Microsoft Q&A.
4. Enter reply into rich-text editor.
5. Click "Send" button.

From question thread with private messages

1. Go to a question you asked that has a private message.
2. Open private messages modal – by clicking link in blue banner or private messages button.
3. Private messages modal opens
4. Enter reply into rich-text editor.
5. Click "Send" button.

Text editor

We use the same text editor for private messages that we use elsewhere on the Q&A platform! You can utilize the full rich-text editor while exchanging private messages, including attachment and draft autosave functionality.

New filters – View questions with private messages

There is a new filter available allowing users to filter by questions with private messages. This will be critical for Microsoft moderators to manage ongoing conversations with multiple users. NOTE: You must be signed into your Learn profile to use this filter.

Notification

Adjust your email preferences within Learn settings.

1. Click on "Settings" through the user menu.
2. Navigate to "Q&A preferences".
3. There is a setting called "Private message notifications."
4. Toggle on/off to enable/disable instant email notifications for private messages from Microsoft moderators.

Privacy

We take steps to protect any sensitive data! In compliance with privacy regulations, we delete all private messages in a conversation 30 days following the first message sent by a Microsoft moderator. We do not keep fragments of a conversations and delete message by message, and instead we delete the entire conversation after 30 days from the first message the Microsoft moderator sent to the question author.

Frequently asked questions

Who can view my private messages?

The questions author and any Microsoft moderators.

What is approved to be discussed in private messages?

This is not an exhaustive list of approved topics to discuss in private messages.

1. Email address
2. Support ticket ID
3. Logs, fiddler trace, and HAR files etc (where possible, please scrub any PII before uploading to minimize risk.)

4. Key vault keys information
5. Code snippets
6. Azure subscription ID or tenant ID
7. Teams meeting details, if needed to troubleshoot

Why can't I view a private message?

Sometimes, you may click "Reply" from an email notification about a private message, and the message won't open! This is because the private message(s) has been deleted. There are two potential reasons for this:

1. Microsoft moderator deleted their message.
2. 30-day private message retention period: All private messages in a conversation are deleted 30 days after the Microsoft moderator sends the first private message.

Can I edit my private message?

Yes, you can edit any of the private messages you have sent within the 30-day retention period.

1. Open private message modal from email notification, banner on question thread, or button on question thread.
2. Click the overflow menu for the message you would like to edit.
3. Make desired changes to the content.
4. Click "Save" button.

Can I delete my private message?

No; at this time, only Microsoft moderators can delete their own private messages. We eventually plan to support question authors deleting their own private messages.

What happens to my private messages if I delete my account?

If the question author involved in a private conversation deletes their account within the 30-day retention period, we immediately close and delete the conversation for all participants, instead of waiting until the 30 days to delete.

Guidelines for posting a quality answer on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 06/26/2023

Quality answers on Microsoft Q&A drive greater customer satisfaction and encourage users to ask more questions. This article outlines the guidelines for posting a quality answer on Microsoft Q&A. It aims to help you deliver quality answers by highlighting best practices and guidelines. To provide a quality answer, you should:

- [Understand the question](#)
- [Consider your audience](#)
- [Break the answer into sections](#)
- [Add visuals](#)
- [Reference the word of others](#)
- [Check your answer for relevancy](#)

Understand the question

The initial step in delivering a quality answer is to have a complete understanding of the issue or question posed by the user. It's common for users to leave out important details or assume you're familiar with their setup. If the question is unclear, it's okay to ask for clarification. Consider the following:

- Ensure that you have a clear understanding of what is being asked before responding. Ask yourself: Am I confident in understanding the user's question? Do I need to request more information?
- Utilize comments to obtain additional information or seek clarification from the person who asked the question. Sometimes, additional context, a screenshot, or rewording the question can make a significant impact.

Consider your audience

When answering a question, it's important to keep in mind the larger audience you're helping. While your answer may be focused on the specific user who asked the question, adding more information can make it more valuable to others who may be searching for similar answers in the future.

Organize your answer for clarity

When answering a question, start by briefly summarizing the issue and restating the question. This confirms that you understand the problem and makes your answer more accessible for others who may be browsing the conversation for a similar issue.

Divide your answer into clear and concise sections, no longer than a few paragraphs each. This helps to present the information in an organized and easily digestible manner. If there are multiple questions related to the issue, be sure to clearly distinguish and emphasize the answers in your response.

Use screenshots to illustrate your answers

To enhance the clarity and impact of your answers, consider including screenshots whenever possible.

Highlight key areas using boxes or arrows and make sure the image clearly illustrates what you're trying to convey. To provide context for the reader, consider including a navigation bar, breadcrumb trail, or other elements that show the location. Consider adding a border to distinguish the screenshot text from the answer text.

The most popular answers tend to be those that include clear, helpful images.

Important

Make sure to edit out sensitive information like subscription IDs.

Credit sources in your answers

When answering questions, it's important to acknowledge the work of others and provide proper credit. This can be done by including links to relevant resources along with the name of the author and the context for the link.

Quoting relevant information and providing an overview of why the resource is helpful can also be useful in case the resource becomes unavailable in the future.

Plagiarism or claiming the work of others as your own, is not allowed and answers identified as such will be deleted and your account might be suspended. For more information, see the the [Microsoft Q&A community guidelines](#).

Check your answer for relevancy

Once you're finished with the answer, read the question once more and review your answer to make sure it covers all the user's concerns. This is specially important for complex scenarios. Additionally, remove excessive details and any information that is not related to the question.

Tagging on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

A tag is a keyword or label that categorizes your question with other, similar questions. Microsoft Q&A previously used a "free form" tagging experience where a question author could select up to 5 tags as necessary. The *new* tagging system uses a hierarchy to help route a question to the most appropriate experts. A question will have only 1 hierarchical tag.

Tags *
Select tags from the dropdowns below.

Select a tag *

Windows

Select a child tag *

Windows Client for IT Pros

What happens to questions using the old tagging experience?

Existing questions using the "free form" tagging experience will persist. Making [edits](#) to these questions will require using the new hierarchical tagging system.

Last updated on 03/06/2026

Q&A Autotagging: Get Fast & Accurate Question Tags with AI



Summarize this article for me

- Q&A Autotagging is a feature that provides five AI-generated tag options after you draft a question on Q&A and press a button prompting tag generation.
- This service reduces user burden by eliminating the manual tagging requirement and contributes to accurate tagging and effective question routing through an efficient, automated system.

Q&A Autotagging Limitations

Q&A Autotagging has the following limitations:

- **Language:** Autotagging only supports the EN-US locale. If you're posting a question in a non-EN-US locale, the default manual tagging dropdowns are provided.
- **Unsupported Products:** If your question pertains to a product not within the Q&A product taxonomy, this service doesn't provide AI-generated tag options. The model outputs "Microsoft Q&A > Not Supported" as the only available tag for your question. In these cases, you're encouraged to edit your question or use the manual tagging dropdowns.
- **Accuracy:** This service doesn't fully eliminate user involvement in tag selection. The feature outputs the top five tags most likely aligned to your question, from which you select one. Our model doesn't currently support the generation of a single correct tag for a question. We'll use accuracy data from this service to tune the model toward a more accurate, fully autonomous tag-generation system.

How to Use Q&A Auto tagging

1. When you draft a question on Q&A, you enter information into the "Title" and "Details" sections.
2. When you're finished typing your question, select **Generate tags** to prompt the generation of AI-generated tag options.
3. You see five tag options suggested based on your question. Each tag option encompasses a complete product tag hierarchy (tag, child tag, etc.) appropriate to your question.

4. If you make a modification to your question after generating tags, select **Regenerate tags** to get tag options for your updated question.
5. Once you select a tag, you can post your question.
6. If you aren't satisfied with any of the AI-generated tag options, you can opt to tag your question manually using the dropdown functionality.

Evaluation of Q&A Auto tagging

- Moderators review the tags assigned to posted questions for accuracy and they correct them if needed. We collect data on the rate at which tags are edited by moderators.
- We also evaluate the rate at which users opt to manually tag their question. This tracks user sentiment and informs model performance.
- We use this performance data to improve the accuracy of the autotagging system.
- We'll improve the autotagger's accuracy until it's prepared to serve as a fully automated system outputting a single, accurate tag to your question without requiring user input.

Last updated on 03/06/2026

Answer questions on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

Answering questions on Microsoft Q&A helps other users solve their problem and increase your reputation.

You can also answer your own question to help other community members to resolve the same issue you were facing.

Prerequisites

You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).

Limitations

Limitations when mentioning a user:

- Typing a comma stops searching for the user.
- There may be a delay between the time a user creates a profile on Microsoft Learn and the time they can be mentioned. If you can't find the user and it's their first question, try again in a few minutes.

Answer a question

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to answer.
2. Scroll down until you see the "Your answer" header.
3. Enter your answer on the rich-web editor.
4. Insert [attachments](#).
5. Make sure you [mention](#) the question author or any other relevant users.
6. Select the "Post your answer" button.
7. Answers are sorted by most helpful votes. If two or more answers have the same number of helpful votes, then they're sorted from oldest to newest.

Include attachments

Use the rich-web editor to enter the details of your question. Use [attachments](#) to help illustrate your answer.

Mention a user

Mention question authors help them know that you answer your question. You can also mention other users who contributed to the thread. If they have their [email notifications](#) enabled, they get a message.

1. In the rich-web editor, type @.
2. Start typing the user's name.
3. When you find a match, press ENTER or select the name.

ⓘ Note

The list of users matching is 30. You will see first the list of display names that matches the start the string you type, in alphabetical order. The list is followed by matches that contain the display name you're typing, as well sorted in alphabetical order.

Next steps

- Learn [How to write a quality answer](#) on Microsoft Q&A.
- Get familiar with the [Q&A code of conduct](#), including crediting your sources, when you don't come up with the answer on your own.
- Share your expertise, help other community members, and help [answering question on Microsoft Q&A](#).

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Answer your own questions on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 03/30/2023

Microsoft Q&A supports users potentially answering their own questions on Microsoft Q&A. Sharing the answers to existing questions is very valuable for the rest of the users who might be facing the same question. There are few cases when this might happen:

1. The question author asked the question on Microsoft Q&A and later they found the answer themselves after further investigation, talking to colleagues, or in a different non-public venue.
2. A Microsoft support engineer got a question from a customer as a support ticket or another private venue and they found the answer will be beneficial for the larger community. Therefore, they post the question on behalf of the user together with the answer.

Guidelines

Once you provide the answer to the question (do not share yours or other's private and confidential information), make sure that:

1. Provide a note where you found the answer, if applicable. For example, a Microsoft support engineer should say: "The question and answer were raised in a non-public venue."
2. Link to this article so people know the reason of self-answering.
3. NEVER take credit from other user's work (plagiarism), so if somebody else offered you help privately, try to give credit.
4. Leave the question open, so other members of the community can comment and add additional answers. Closing the question will prevent other users to add additional information or add answers down the road if the answer changes overtime.
5. Do not bring content from another public site (MSDN or TechNet forums, Stack Overflow, etc.). Users will be able to find that content either via organic search or when they ask a question in Microsoft Q&A. There is not need to duplicate content in multiple places.
6. The intent of this self-answering provision on Microsoft Q&A is to post questions that require detailed answers which provide a resolution to an issue impacting a broad range of customers. It is not intended to be used to post short informational

items that would be better suited on a product/service summary page or listed as part of a frequently asked questions page.

Add comments to Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

Comments are brief messages that anybody can use for the following scenarios:

- Clarify a question, answer, or comment or add more information.
- Share tips on how the user might research the answer to their question.
- Suggest ways to improve the question or answer.
- Follow up with customers on abandoned threads.
- Redirect customers to a different site. Be sure to always provide the proper context when linking to information on sites outside of Microsoft Q&A.
- Comments should be short and to the point.

Prerequisites

You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).

Limitations

- You can add a comment only for a question or an answer.
- The comments editor for answers is hidden by default. Select the bubble icon to show it.

Limitations when mentioning a user:

- Typing a comma will stop searching for the user.
- There might be a delay since a user creates a profile in Microsoft Learn until you can mention. If you cannot find the user and this is their first question, try again in a few minutes.

Add a comment

1. From the [Questions page](#), select any question you would like to add a comment to.
2. Enter text on the "Add a comment" text box for a question or an answer.
3. Make sure you [mention](#) the question author or any other relevant users.
4. Select the "Add comment" button.
5. You will see the comment you're posted as the last one, as comments are sorted from oldest to newest.

Attachments

Use the rich-web editor to enter the details of your question. Avoid including images from the web as certain domains will be blocked and eventually the images might not be available. Use [attachments](#) to illustrate your point.

Mention a user

Mention question authors on a comment help them know that you might need more information about their question. You can also mention other users to seek their input, for example. If they have their [mail notifications](#) enabled, they will get a message.

1. In the rich-web editor, type @.
2. Start typing the user's name.
3. When you find a match, press ENTER or select the name.

Note

The list of users matching is 30. You will see first the list of display names that matches the start the string you type, in alphabetical order. The list is followed by matches that contain the display name you're typing, as well sorted in alphabetical order.

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Accept an answer on Microsoft Q&A

10/01/2025

An accepted answer is the answer that the person who asked the question chooses as the one they think best solves their problem.

Only the question author can accept an answer to their question on Microsoft Q&A. Accepting an answer helps other users to know the answer helped the question author and might help them with same or similar problem.

An accepted answer is not always the best or final answer; it just means it solved the problem for the person who asked the question. Other users may prefer different answers depending on their specific needs.

Prerequisites

- You need to be signed into Q&A.
- You need to be the question author.

Limitations

- You can only accept answers from other users.

Accept an answer

Accepting an answer helps other community members to know the answer helped you. It's also a way to thank and recognize the person who helped you.

1. Go to a question you asked AND that has answers.
2. Review the answers and select the "Accept answer" button underneath the answer.
3. The answer is accepted and moved up after the question. The accepted answer has a green frame to visually indicate that it's the accepted answer and the "Accepted answer" label.

Remove an accepted answer

You can change your mind and decide that an answer didn't help you solve your problem. In this case, you can undo the accept answer action.

1. Go to the question you asked that has the accepted answer.
2. Select the "Accept answer" button underneath the accepted answer.
3. You see a dialog asking you if you want to remove the accepted answer.
4. Select "Yes" and the answer is no longer be accepted.

Change an accepted answer

You might get one or more answers after you accepted the answer. One of them might provide a better way to solve your problem. You can easily change the accepted answer or accept more answers if several solutions are helpful.

Next steps

Help other community members by [accepting answers on your questions](#).

Add attachments to Microsoft Q&A

Article • 06/26/2023

Attachments are essential for users to complement their questions, answers, or comments. Thus, you can insert one or multiple files and images on any of your questions, answers, or comments.

Prerequisites

You need to be signed in Q&A.

Limitations

Attachment type	Extension
File	XML, PDF, TXT, LOG, GIF, PNG, JPG, JPEG
Image	GIF, PNG, JPG, JPEG

Attachment requirement	Value
Minimum number	0
Maximum number	20
Minimum size per file	1 byte
Maximum size per file	3 MB

Inserting images from the web

Referencing images from the web to support your question, answer is limited tot he following domains:

1. *.microsoft.com
2. *.githubusercontent.com
3. *.github.com*azure.net
4. *.azureedge.net
5. *.windows.net
6. *.office.net
7. *.visualstudio.com
8. *.linkedin.com

9. *.imgur.com

10. *.giphy.com

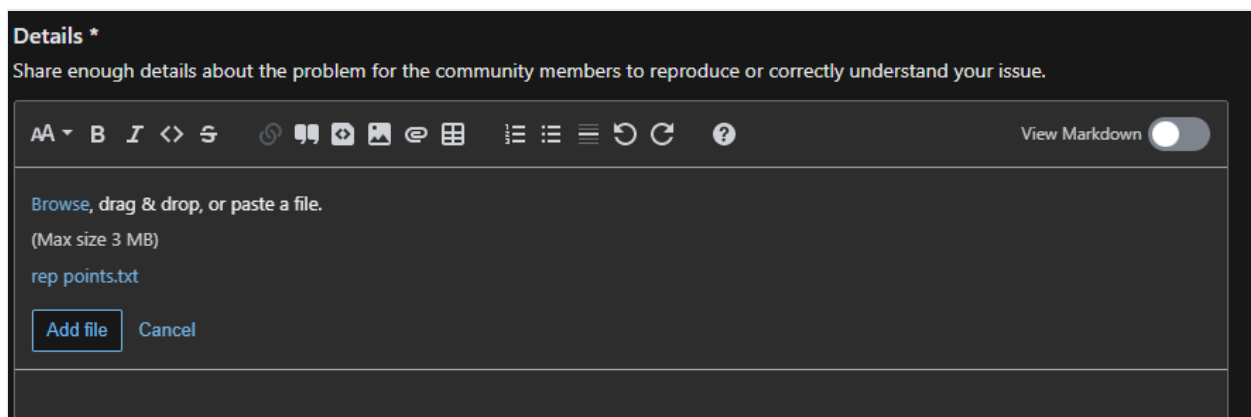
If you copy an image from a web page, make sure you're aware of its copyright limitations and you always cite the source.

Keeping our users safe

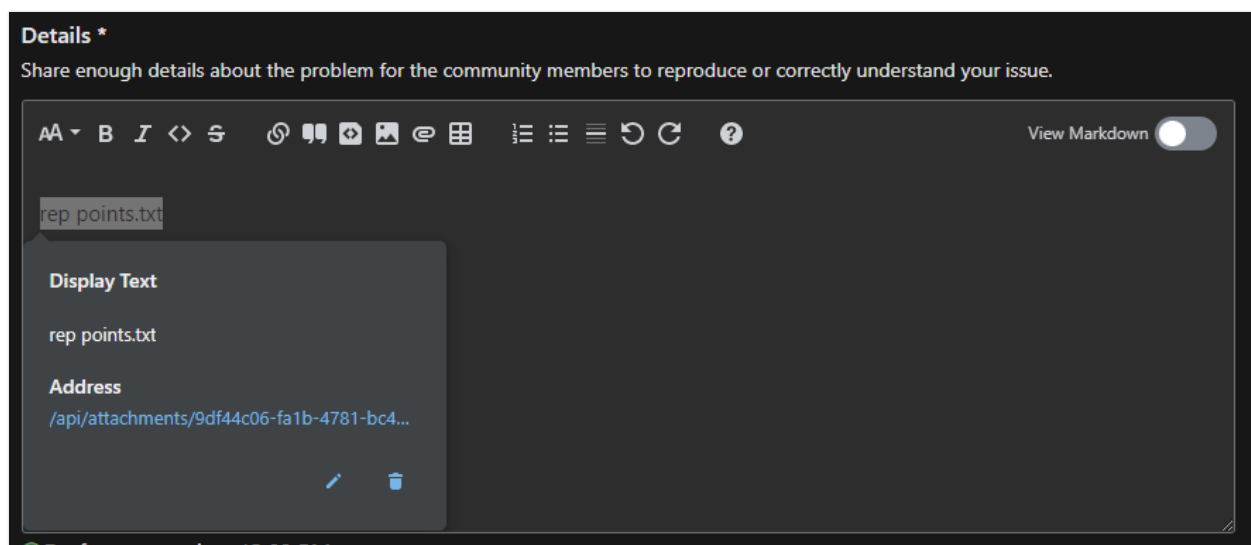
- Users won't be able to see the [Exif information](#) [↗](#).
- When a user deletes their account, we will keep the attachments on the content and anonymize them, so there is no connection between the user and the attachment (similar with what we do for content).
- Any malware file will be automatically removed.

Copy and paste or drag and drop

You can copy and paste a file or image from your clipboard or drag and drop to the editor directly. After you paste it, you will see a link or preview of the file and an "Add file" button, so you can add the file if that is the one you intended.

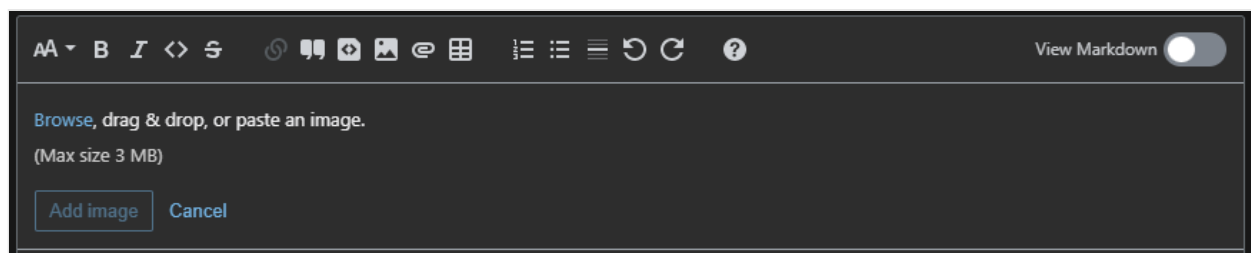


Once you have added the attachment, you will see a popup with the file information, including the link to the local storage and the option to point to a different file on your machine or on the web. The popup also shows when the user hovers the file link.

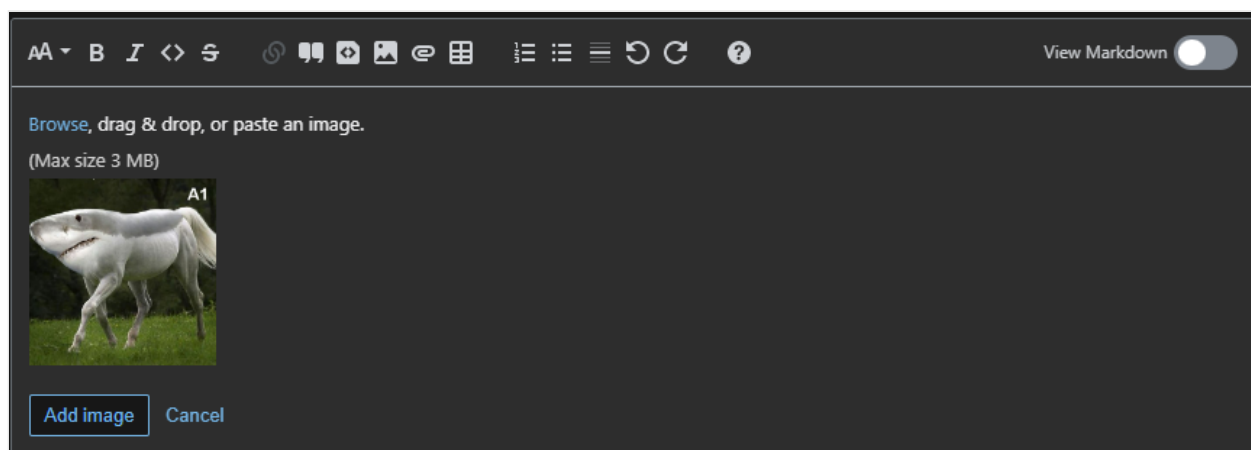


Browse and upload from your computer

To browse an attachment in your computer, you can select either the "Image" or "File" icon on the editor's toolbar. Like before, you will see an embedded dialog in the editor telling you can Browse, drag & drop, or paste an image.



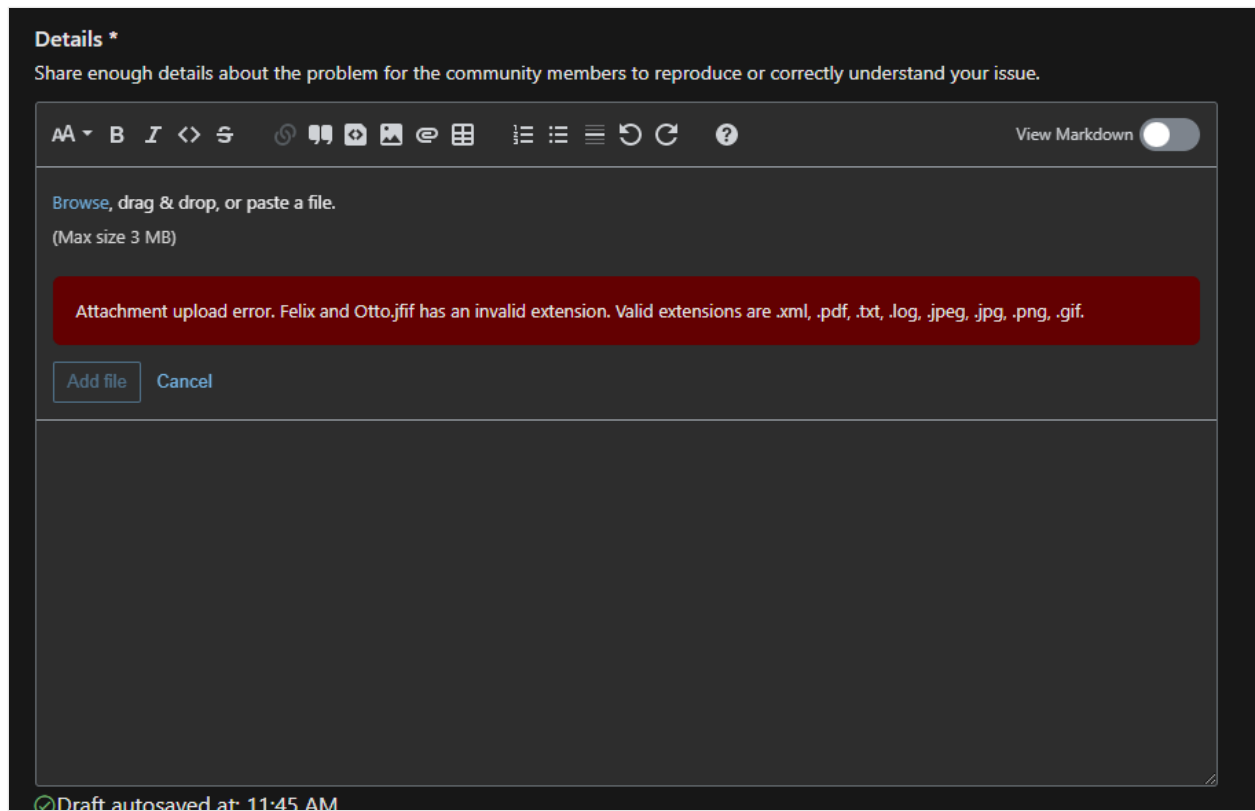
When the user selects "Browse", they see the preview of the image and the "Add image" button to confirm this is the one they want to insert.



Error messages

If the attachment doesn't meet one of the requirements, you will see an error before posting the content. An example of an invalid extension error message is shown in the

screen below.



Microsoft Q&A Markdown reference

Article • 06/26/2023

Microsoft Q&A supports a rich-web editor experience, so you would never have to worry about editing the content in Markdown. In the case you do, here is a reference for writing Markdown for Q&A.

[Markdown](#) is a lightweight markup language with plain text formatting syntax.

`learn.microsoft.com` (Learn) supports CommonMark compliant Markdown parsed through the [Markdig](#) parsing engine. Learn and Q&A also supports custom Markdown extensions that provide richer content on the site. Q&A uses a subset of the extensions supported in Learn' documentation. This article provides an alphabetical reference.

You can see more information on the [Learn Markdown reference](#) article.

Code snippets

Block quote

markdown

```
> This example is a blockquote. It's usually rendered indented and with a
different background color.
```

The preceding example renders as follows:

This is a blockquote. It's usually rendered indented and with a different background color.

Code blocks

You can add the code language to a code block for richer rendering.

markdown

```
```csharp
 public static void Log(string message)
 {
 _logger.LogInformation(message);
 }
...
```
```

The preceding example renders as follows:

C#

```
public static void Log(string message)
{
    _logger.LogInformation(message);
}
```

Emojis

Q&A will convert an emoji short code to its respective Unicode characters:

markdown

This is a test with a :).

The preceding example renders as follows:

This is a test with a 😊.

Formatting

To format text as **bold**, enclose it in two asterisks:

markdown

This text is ***bold***.

To format text as *italic*, enclose it in a single asterisk:

markdown

This text is *italic*.

To format text as both ***bold and italic***, enclose it in three asterisks:

markdown

This text is both ***bold and italic***.

To format text as ~~strikeout~~, enclose it with two surrounding it by two tildes:

markdown

```
This text is ~~strikeout~~.
```

Headers

Q&A supports six levels of Markdown headings:

markdown

```
# This is a first level heading (H1)

## This is a second level heading (H2)

...

##### This is a sixth level heading (H6)
```

- There must be a space between the last # and heading text.
- Each question, answer, or comment must have one and only one H1 heading.

HTML

If you enter HTML content, then content will not be rendered. Instead, it will show as plain text.

Images

The Learn custom `:::image:::` extension supports standard images, complex images, and icons.

Markdown

```
:::image source="<folderOrURLPath>" alt-text="<alt text>":::
```

Where `<alt text>` is a brief description of the image and `<folderOrURLPath>` is a relative path to the image or its URL. Alternate text is required for screen readers for the visually impaired. It's also useful if there's a site bug where the image can't render. Don't copy file names for use as alt text. For example, instead of this:

markdown

```
:::image source="./media/bogusfilename/ADextension_2FA_Configure_Step4.PNG"
alt-text="ADextension_2FA_Configure_Step4":::
```

Write this:

markdown

```
:::image source="./media/bogusfilename/ADextension_2FA_Configure_Step4.PNG"
alt-text="Active Directory extension for two-factor authentication, step 4:
Configure":::
```

Links

Links are easy to add in Q&A. Links point users to content another page in Q&A or another trusted source.

markdown

```
[Link text](<FullURL>).
```

markdown

```
[Microsoft Q&A products page](/answers/products).`
```

Link text

The words that you include in the link text should be friendly. In other words, they should be normal English words or the title of the page that you're linking to.

Do not use "select here." for the "Link text". It's bad for search engine optimization and doesn't adequately describe the target.

Important

All links must be secure (`https` vs `http`) whenever the target supports it (which the vast majority should).

Example:

For more information, see the [Microsoft Q&A products page](/answers/products).

The above example renders as:

For more information, see the [Microsoft Q&A products page](#).

Auto links

Links will be autoformatted for any string that starts by: `https://`, `https://`, `ftp://`, `mailto:`, `tel:`, or `www.` (resolves to `https://www.`)

Lists (Numbered, Bulleted)

Numbered list

To create a numbered list, you can use all 1s. The numbers are rendered in ascending order as a sequential list when published. For increased source readability, you can increase your lists manually.

Don't use letters in lists, including nested lists. They don't render correctly when published. Nested lists using numbers will render as lowercase letters when published. For example:

markdown

```
1. This is
1. a parent numbered list
    1. and this is
    1. a nested numbered list
1. (fin)
```

This renders as follows:

1. This is
2. a parent numbered list
 - a. and this is
 - b. a nested numbered list
3. (fin)

Bulleted list

To create a bulleted list, use `-` or `*` followed by a space at the beginning of each line:

markdown

- This is
- a parent bulleted list
 - and this is
 - a nested bulleted list
- All done!

This renders as follows:

- This is
- a parent bulleted list
 - and this is
 - a nested bulleted list
- All done!

Whichever syntax you use, `-` or `*`, use it consistently in your content.

Tables

The simplest way to create a table in Markdown is to use pipes and lines. To create a standard table with a header, follow the first line with dashed line:

markdown

```
This is	a simple	table header
table	data	here
it doesn't	actually	have to line up nicely!
```

This renders as follows:

| This is | a simple | table header |
|----------------|-----------------|-------------------------|
| table | data | here |
| it doesn't | actually | have to line up nicely! |

Search for Microsoft Q&A content

Article • 06/26/2023

You can find questions and answers by utilizing Microsoft Learn search.

How to search for Q&A content

You can type your search term on the top-right control you will see on every page. If you're familiar with `learn.microsoft.com`, you will realize it's the same control that is available on each of the site pages.

As you type terms, you will see autosuggestions for the term you're typing. You can either select one or press ENTER to search for the term you're typing.

On the search page, you will see that the results are automatically scoped to Q&A, so you can stay focused on that content area.

The results card shows the following information:

- A selectable title.
- The URL path of the question.
- A semantic matching of the term against the question or the answer contents.
- Whether the question has any answers. if so, how many are accepted.
- Last time the question thread was updated.
- Who asked the question and when.

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Learn search interface. On the left, there is a 'Filter' sidebar with a 'Content area' section. The 'Q&A' option is selected, and a list of counts for various content areas is shown: All (2M), Documentation (394K), Learn (4.3K), Certifications (409), Q&A (236), Reference (1.6M), Shows (8K), and Events (5.8K). The main search bar contains the text 'how to use azure portal' and a 'Search' button. Below the search bar, it states '236 results for "how to use azure portal" in Q&A'. The results list includes four items, each with a title, URL, and metadata. The first item is 'How to use azure portal? - Microsoft Q&A' with URL '/answersv2/questions/10864/how-to-use-azure-portal'. The second item is 'Azure lab-services, what is it about and how can I leverage it? - Microsoft Q&A' with URL '/answersv2/questions/9699/azure-lab-services-what-is-it-about-and-how-can-i-'. The third item is 'How to access keys in azure redis? - Microsoft Q&A' with URL '/answersv2/questions/9660/how-to-access-keys-in-azure-redis'. The fourth item is 'how does Role based access control work in Azure AD? - Microsoft Q&A' with URL '/answersv2/questions/7090/how-does-role-based-access-control-work-in-azure-a'. Each item shows '0 answers' and 'Last updated on [date]'. The fourth item also shows '1 answer' and 'Last updated on May 13, 2020'.

Filter
Clear all

Content area

- All (2M)
- Documentation (394K)
- Learn (4.3K)
- Certifications (409)
- Q&A (236)**
- Reference (1.6M)
- Shows (8K)
- Events (5.8K)

Search: how to use azure portal

236 results for "how to use azure portal" in Q&A

How to use azure portal? - Microsoft Q&A
/answersv2/questions/10864/how-to-use-azure-portal
How to use azure portal? - Microsoft Q&A /answersv2/questions/10864/how-to-use-azure-portal. How to use azure portal?. How to use azure portal?
0 answers Last updated on Aug 27, 2020 asked Aug 27, 2020 by Yan Xie 42 Microsoft Employee

Azure lab-services, what is it about and how can I leverage it? - Microsoft Q&A
/answersv2/questions/9699/azure-lab-services-what-is-it-about-and-how-can-i-
Azure lab-services, what is it about and how can I leverage it? - Microsoft Q&A /answersv2/questions/9699/azure-lab-services-what-is-it-about-and-how-can-i-. Azure lab-services, what is it about and how can I leverage it?. Azure lab-services, what is it about and how can I leverage it?
0 answers Last updated on Jul 22, 2020 asked Jul 22, 2020 by Yan Xie 42 Microsoft Employee

How to access keys in azure redis? - Microsoft Q&A
/answersv2/questions/9660/how-to-access-keys-in-azure-redis
How to access keys in azure redis? - Microsoft Q&A /answersv2/questions/9660/how-to-access-keys-in-azure-redis. How to do this in azure redis?. How to do this in azure redis?
0 answers Last updated on Jul 22, 2020 asked Jul 22, 2020 by Yan Xie 42 Microsoft Employee

how does Role based access control work in Azure AD? - Microsoft Q&A
/answersv2/questions/7090/how-does-role-based-access-control-work-in-azure-a
- Microsoft Q&A /answersv2/questions/7090/how-does-role-based-access-control-work-in-azure-a. I am trying to implement RBAC in my azure environment . However I am not able to understand how to create a custom roles as per my organisation needs. Can someone help with the same..
1 answer Last updated on May 13, 2020 asked May 13, 2020 by Yan Xie 42 Microsoft Employee

If you want to expand the search to other content areas using the same search term, you can do that by selecting on "All" or any of the available options in the "Content

area" filter area.

Filter and sort content on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 01/24/2025

Filtering and sorting allows you to build a unique view of the content you're interested in, based on what you're trying to do in Q&A.

Prerequisites

You need to be signed into Q&A to use the "My content" filter.

Limitations

- You can only pick one filter and one sort option.
- For things you follow, we will only show you the last 400 items.

Filter in Questions and Tag details pages

The Questions and Tag details pages share the same filtering options.

On the "Filters" option on the left, select one of the following options:

 Expand table

| Option | Explanation |
|------------------------|---|
| All | Shows all the questions. |
| No answers | Shows questions without an answer. |
| Has answers | Shows questions with at least one answer. |
| No answers or comments | Shows questions without an answer or a comment. |
| With accepted answer | Shows questions with an accepted answer. |
| My content | Shows any questions you contributed to (asked, answered, commented, or edited). |
| Questions I follow | Shows any questions you follow. |

Sort questions in Questions and Tag details pages

The Questions and Tag details pages share the same sorting options.

On the "Short by" option on the right, select one of the following options:

 Expand table

| Option | Explanation |
|-------------------|---|
| Updated (DEFAULT) | Shows questions ordered from newest to oldest based on their last updated time. Updated means asked, answered, commented, marked as answered, edited, voted/rated. |
| Created | Shows questions ordered from newest to oldest based on when a user posted the question object. |
| Answers | Shows questions ordered from the most to the least number of answers. If there are two or more questions with the same number of answers, then we sort by Updated date. |

Filter in the Question details page

There are not filters in this page.

Sort in the Questions details page

Comments for both questions and comments are sorted from oldest to newest on creation date, to ensure you can follow the conversation chronologically.

You can sort the way answers are displayed on the Question details page.

Note

Accepted answers always show right after the question, and they do not follow any sorting.

 Expand table

| Option | Explanation |
|---------------------------|--|
| Most helpful
(DEFAULT) | Answers ordered by number of helpful votes. If two or more answers have the same amount of votes, the answers are sorted from oldest to newest. |
| Newest | Answers ordered from newest to oldest based on their last updated time. Updated means asked, answered, commented, marked as answered, edited, voted/rated. |
| Oldest | Answers ordered from oldest to newest based on their last updated time. Updated means asked, answered, commented, marked as answered, edited, voted/rated. |

Filter in Tags page

The Questions and Tag details pages share the same filtering options.

On the "Filters" option on the left, select one of the following options:

 Expand table

| Option | Explanation |
|---------------|--------------------------------|
| All tags | Shows all the tags in Q&A. |
| Tags I follow | Shows all the tags you follow. |

Sorting in the Tags page

 Expand table

| Option | Explanation |
|----------------------|--|
| Popular
(DEFAULT) | Shows questions per tag in descending order (tag with the most questions appear first). In case two or more tags have the same number of questions, then the order based on name (English A-Z alphabetical order). |
| Name | English A-Z alphabetical order from the tag's display label. |

Report content for moderation on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 01/24/2025

Any authenticated user can report any content (question, answer, or comment) for moderation that they feel it doesn't follow [Q&A Code of Conduct](#). A moderator reviews the report and acts upon it. For more information about type of reports and moderation actions, see the [Q&A Code of Conduct](#).

The EU Digital Safety Act (DSA) gives you the right to be informed about the outcome of your content reports. You can enter your email address when you report an issue, and we use it only for that specific case. It doesn't affect your [e-mail preferences](#) for Microsoft Q&A. Similarly, if you're the content owner and a moderator removes your content, we let you know by email if we have it.

Prerequisites

You need to be signed into Q&A.

Limitations

You can't undo a report action.

Report a question or an answer

1. Go to the question or answer you would like to report.
2. Select the "Report" option (Flag icon) underneath the question or answer.
3. Select one of the reasons from the drop-down in the "Report a concern" dialog. If you select "Other", add additional information to help understand the moderator the reason for the reporting.
4. Share your e-mail address with us if you want to get updates on the content you reported.
5. Select "Submit" button.
6. A moderator reviews the content and act on it.

Report a comment

1. Go to the comment you would like to report.

2. Select the overflow menu (the three vertical dots, and then "Report").
3. Select one of the reasons from the drop-down in the "Report a concern" dialog. If you select "Other", add additional information to help understand the moderator the reason for the reporting.
4. Share your e-mail address with us if you want to get updates on the content you reported.
5. Select "Submit" button.
6. A moderator reviews the content and act on it.

See reported content

Any reported content has a "Reported" label at the top of the content that was reported. You still see the content on the site.

Microsoft Q&A banners

Article • 06/26/2023

Banners are used on Microsoft Q&A to make different announcements:

1. A unified user experience across the Learn site.
2. Banners can have formatting, links, and a call to action.
3. Banners can be added at the Q&A site level, at a specific page (such as a Tag page), or a set of URLs.
4. Banners have an expiration date, so they're targeted to specific scenarios.
5. Users can dismiss the banner if it doesn't apply to them.

Banners are dismissible. If you select the banner close button, the banner will be hidden, and the action is stored in your browser local storage. This means that the banner won't reappear unless you remove the key "dismissed-banner" from local storage.

Limitations

- There is only one banner at at time on a page.

Follow on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 01/24/2025

Microsoft Q&A users need the ability to stay updated on the content relevant to them. One of the ways is using the following functionality that supports a user to follow a Q&A question, tag, or user.

Prerequisites

You need to be signed into Q&A.

Limitations

- A user can follow a deleted question.
- A user can follow a question under moderation.

Follow a question

1. Open the question you would like to follow.
2. Select the "Follow" button in the Activity sidebar.
3. The "Follow" button changes to "Following".

Unfollow a question

1. Open any of the questions you're following.
2. Select the "Following" in the Activity sidebar.
3. The "Following" button changes to "Follow".

Follow a tag from the Tags page

1. Go to the [Tags](#) page.
2. Look for the tag you would like to follow.
3. Select the "Follow" button within the tag card.
4. The "Follow" button changes to "Following".

Unfollow a tag from the Tags page

1. Go to the [Tags](#) page.

2. Look for the tag you're following.
3. Select the "Following" button within the tag card.
4. The "Following" button changes to "Follow".

Follow a tag from the Question details page

1. Open a question that has a tag that you would like to follow.
2. Select the tag you would like to follow. The tag card appears.
3. Select the "Follow" button within the tag card.
4. The "Follow" button changes to "Following".

Unfollow a tag from the Question details page

1. Open a question that has a tag that you're following.
2. Select the tag you're following. The tag card appears.
3. Select the "Following" button within the tag card.
4. The "Following" button changes to "Follow".

Follow a tag from the Tag details page

1. Go to the [Tags](#) page.
2. Look for the tag you would like to follow.
3. Select the "Follow" button within the tag card.
4. The "Follow" button changes to "Following".

Unfollow a tag from the Tag details page

1. Go to the [Tags](#) page.
2. Look for the tag you would like to unfollow.
3. Select the "Following" button within the tag card.
4. The "Following" button changes to "Follow".

Follow a user

1. Open any of the questions.
2. Select "Follow" next to the user's display name.
3. The "Follow" button changes to "Following".

Unfollow a user

1. Open any of the questions where a user you're following has participated.
2. Select "Following" next to the user's display name.
3. The "Following" button changes to "Follow".

Vote on a question on Microsoft Q&A

If you find a question describing the issue you're facing, vote on that question. This can help users who are answering to prioritize those questions that affect many users.

Limitations

You cannot vote on your own question.

Vote on an question

You can vote on somebody's question to indicate that you have the same issue. We also recommend you to [follow that question](#) so you can stay up to date on any activity.

1. Open the question that describes the same issue you have.
2. Select "I have the same question" link.
3. You will see an indication that you have voted on the same question. If other users have voted on that question, the total number will increase by 1.

To remove your vote, select again on "I have the same question".

Next steps

[Follow a question](#)

Last updated on 04/17/2026

Rate answers on Microsoft Q&A

Rating answers is essential for you to let other users know whether an answer helped you solve your problem. Thus, if a question has multiple answers, a person with a similar issue might look at the ones that help the most users, increasing the likelihood that the answer will also help them.

You can vote "Yes" or "No" on an answer. Any user will see how many people have voted on the answer. "No" votes are not displayed, and they don't have any effect on the total number of "Yes" votes.

Limitations

- You cannot rate your own answer.
- Microsoft Q&A doesn't display the "No" votes on an answer.

Question author rates an answer on their question

You can rate an answer to your question to indicate other users that the answer helped you. If it did not, the team supporting that question might follow up with you.

1. Open the question where you received the answer.
2. Navigate to the answer that you would like to rate.
3. Next to "Did this solve your problem?", select "Yes" if the answer helped you. Otherwise, select "No".
4. If you select "Yes", you will see a new label saying that you found this answer helpful. To save you time, if there were no accepted answers to the question, Q&A automatically marks the [answer as accepted](#).
5. If you vote "No", the support team is interested in learning more so they can help you further. So please include any additional feedback. If you would like us to contact you in case we have further questions, please provide your e-mail address.

To remove your vote, select again on the same button you selected last time.

To change your vote, select the opposite button you initially selected. Changing your vote will not remove the accepted answer state.

Rate an answer on somebody else's question

You can rate an answer to another user's question. This adds a vote to the answer that will help other users the answer relevancy.

1. Open the question that has the answer you would like to vote.
2. Navigate to the answer.
3. Next to "Was this answer helpful?", select "Yes" if the answer helped you. Otherwise, select "No".
4. If you vote "Yes", you will see a new label saying that you found this answer helpful.
5. If you vote "No", there is no further action.

To remove your vote, select again on the same button you selected last time.

To change your vote, select the opposite button you initially selected.

Next steps

[Understanding accepted answers](#)

Last updated on 04/17/2026

Vote on a comment on Microsoft Q&A

If you think a comment provides helpful context or information to the question or answer, please vote on it.

Limitations

You cannot vote on your own comment.

Vote on an question

You can vote on somebody's comment to indicate that the comment is helpful and people should consider it when reading the question or the answer the comment refers to.

1. Open the question with the helpful comment.
2. Find the comment.
3. Select the thumbs up icon. The number of votes for the comment will increase by 1.

To remove your vote, select the thumbs up again.

Last updated on 04/17/2026

Microsoft Q&A permissions

Article • 05/12/2025

These are the permissions users have on Microsoft Q&A.

 Expand table

| Permission type | Authenticated users | Microsoft moderators | Volunteer moderators | Independent advisors |
|---|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Post content (question, answer, or comment) | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| Edit my content: questions (content or tags), answers, or comments | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes |
| View my deleted content (questions, answers, or comments) | No | Yes | Yes | No |
| Edit any content: questions (content or tags), answers, or comments | No | Yes | Yes | No |
| Delete any content (questions, answers, or comments) | No | Yes | Yes | No |
| Lock/unlock questions | No | Yes | Yes | No |
| Unlock migrated questions | No | No | No | No |
| View any deleted content (questions, answers, or comments) | No | Yes | Yes | No |
| Mark questions as duplicate | No | Yes | Yes | No |
| Send private message to question authors | No | Yes | No | No |

Microsoft Q&A moderation

Article • 04/11/2025

Accessing the moderation queue

Moderators will notice a second button labeled "Moderator Tools" adjacent to the "Ask a Question" button in the header. By selecting this button, moderators will be directed to the moderation queue.

Moderation queue

The moderation queue has three tabs:

1. **Reported:** Moderators can see all the content that has been manually reported by other users.
2. **Escalated:** Moderators can see all the content that has been escalated for further review.
3. **Deleted:** Moderators can see all the content that has been deleted.

In all tabs, you can:

- Filter the content by "Suspended users" or "Non-suspended users".
- Sort the content by "Newest", "Oldest", or "By user".

Processing reported content

In this tab, you will see all the content other users have reported for moderation. Here are the actions you can take:

- **Edit reported content:** You can edit the content to remove any content that doesn't follow the guidelines. Note that when you submit the updated content, the content is no longer reported and it gets restored on the site.
- **Approve reported content:** You might find the content was reported by mistake, so you can restore it back to the site.
- **Delete reported content:** This content should not be on the site. Once deleted, the content will only be visible to moderators, and not to other users.
- **Suspend/Unsuspend user:** The user is violating Q&A's [code of conduct](#). This action is reversible.

Processing escalated content

In this tab, you will see all the questions moderators have [escalated](#) for further review and assistance. Here are the actions you can take:

- **Edit escalated content:** You can edit the content to remove any content that doesn't follow the guidelines. Note that when you submit the updated content, the question thread remains in the Escalated queue.
- **Delete escalated content:** This content should not be on the site. Once deleted, the content will only be visible to moderators, and not to other users.
- **Remove escalation:** This action removes the question from the Escalated queue.
- **Suspend/Unsuspend user:** The user is violating Q&A's [code of conduct](#). This action is reversible.

Processing deleted content

There are a few scenarios where the moderators might want to see the full list of content that has been deleted. For example, a moderator might need to understand why content was deleted or restore it after removing inappropriate material.

To view the list, navigate to the moderation queue and select the "Deleted" tab. This section displays all deleted content along with detailed information, including the identity of the person who deleted the content, the time of deletion, and the reason for the deletion.

Actions on the Deleted content page

- **Edit deleted content:** You can edit the content to remove any parts that do not adhere to the guidelines. When you submit the updated content, it will be restored and no longer deleted.
- **Undo delete:** The content may have been deleted by mistake, so you can restore it.
- **Suspend/Unsuspend user:** The user is violating Q&A's [code of conduct](#). This action is reversible.

Suspending users

Moderators on Microsoft Q&A can suspend users who are violating Q&A's [code of conduct](#). Suspending users is a reversible action, and details on removing the suspension are included below.

What actions can a suspended user NOT do?

- Ask a question

- Add an answer
- Add a comment
- Edit their content
- Report content
- Accept answer
- Vote on comments
- Rate questions
- Rate answers

What actions can suspended users still do?

- Share a question thread
- Save a question thread to a collection
- Follow a question thread, user, or tag

Note

Suspending a user doesn't delete any of their content from the site. This requires an additional step to remove the user's posts. For more information, see [Deleting content on Microsoft Q&A](#).

Suspend a user

A moderator can suspend a user from the "Reported", "Escalated" or "Deleted" tab.

1. The user information appears in the center of the reported/escalated/deleted content card.
2. Select the "Suspend user" button.
3. A modal appears asking you to confirm the action. Select "Yes, suspend user" to confirm the action and suspend the user.

QUESTION

Testing a question

Lorem ipsum odor amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Vestibulum massa curabitur aliquet convallis sed ultricies id a. Justo ipsum egestas maximus congue mattis posuere. Turpis inceptos ex taciti tempus torquent semper mauris vulputate.

Testing



Mike Test 0 asked Jan 1, 2025, 12:00 PM

[Suspend user](#)

Deletion details

System deleted Jan 1, 2025, 12:05 PM

Reason: Spam

Additional information: Deleted by self-reporting

[Edit deleted content](#) [Undo delete](#)

Undo suspending a user

A moderator can unsuspend a user from the "Reported", "Escalated" or "Deleted" tab. Doing this will allow the user to participate on the Q&A site again.

For suspended users, the "Suspend user" button is removed and replaced by the "Unsuspend user" button.

1. The user information appears in the center of the reported/escalated/deleted content card.
2. Select the "Unsuspend user" button.
3. A modal appears asking you to confirm the action. Select "Yes, unsuspend user" to confirm the action and restore their permissions on Q&A.

ⓘ Note

Removing a user suspension does not restore their deleted content.

Answer questions about products not supported on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 06/26/2023

Not all Microsoft products are currently supported on Microsoft Q&A, so sometimes content might be posted for those items. A good example is the Power Platform products, which are supported on a separate platform. If you encounter an unsupported product or service on Q&A, you can follow these steps:

1. Provide an answer telling the user that the product is not supported, and send them a link to the site where their question can be posted. For example, questions related to Power Automate are supported in https://powerusers.microsoft.com/t5/Forums/ct-p/FL_Comm_Forums . This action would be considered a best practice.
2. Alternatively, if you have the [permissions](#), [change the question's tag](#) by removing all the tags and add the "Not monitored" tag.

Moderator Recommended Answers



Summarize this article for me

When a helpful reply goes unmarked by the question author, moderators can now step in with a new feature: **Moderator Recommended Answers**. This label helps surface high-quality responses for future readers—without overriding the question author’s authority.

What Is a Moderator Recommended Answer?

A Moderator Recommended Answer is a reply that a moderator believes is accurate, complete, and helpful—even if the question author hasn’t marked it as the accepted solution. It appears with a distinct label to signal trust and improve discoverability.

If the question author later accepts the same reply, the label updates to:
Answer accepted by question author and recommended by moderator

Prerequisites

- You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).
- You need to be a moderator in Q&A.

Why It Matters

Some threads never get marked as answered - especially when the question author doesn’t return. This can leave helpful replies buried and hard to find. Moderator recommendations:

- Highlight trusted solutions
- Improve visibility for future readers
- Help search engines and AI tools prioritize quality content

When to Recommend an Answer

Moderators may recommend a reply when:

- The question author confirms the issue is resolved but hasn’t marked the thread as answered
- The question author shares the solution but is unable to mark it
- At least 72 hours have passed, and two or more users confirmed the solution worked
- The reply has received five or more helpful votes after several days
- The moderator knows from personal experience that the solution is valid

The selected reply should be the most accurate and complete solution - regardless of who posted it.

When Not to Recommend

Avoid recommending a reply if:

- The question author is still active and confirms the issue persists
- The response was just posted - give the question author time to engage
- The reply only asks for more info or clarification
- The reply offers generic troubleshooting steps without addressing the root cause
- The thread lacks a clear solution
- You wrote the answer yourself - in this case, please ask another moderator to recommend it on your behalf

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Edit content on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

If you believe there is an opportunity to improve your content, you are welcome to make edits. Some reasons to edit your content could include:

- Adding more details to your original question to help potential answerers.
- Selecting a more relevant tag to better route your question to experts.
- Adding more details to a comment or answer.

Prerequisites

You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).

Limitations

- Unless you're a moderator, you can only edit your own content.
- Drafts are not saved when editing content. Instead, if you navigate away while editing content without saving, you will get the native browser alert `Changes you made may not be saved.`

Edit a question

You can modify the question details and tag simultaneously. When editing content, you will have access to the complete page for contextual reference.

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to edit.
2. Select the overflow menu on a question.
3. Select "Edit".
4. Update the question details using the editor.
5. Update the tag by using the available dropdown menus.
6. When you're done, select "Save".

ⓘ Note

Microsoft Q&A previously used a "free form" tagging experience where a question author could select up to 5 tags as necessary. The *new* tagging system uses a hierarchy to help route your question to the most appropriate experts. If you choose to edit tags on an existing question, you will be required to use the new tagging system.

Edit an answer

Edit your answer for bigger impact.

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question with an answer you would like to edit.
2. From the answer overflow menu, select "Edit".
3. Update the answer using the editor.
4. When you're done, select "Save".

Edit a comment

Edit your comment for better clarity.

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question with a comment you would like to edit.
2. From the comment overflow menu, select "Edit".
3. Update the comment using the editor.
4. When you're done, select "Save".

If you're a moderator, you will see two saving options: "Save edits and view question" and "Save edits and go to the moderation queue".

- Selecting "Save edits and view question" takes you to the question page, and you see the updated comment.
- Selecting "Save edits and go to the moderation queue" takes you back to the moderation queue. The comment you have edited is no longer in the queue.

Edit deleted content

Editing deleted content automatically restores it. Ensure this is your intent before editing any title, tag, or details.

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Duplicate questions on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 11/15/2023

Sometimes, users ask a question on Q&A that is answered in another question. In those cases, moderators mark it as duplicate to send users to the existing question with answers.

Terminology

- **Source question:** A question that is the same of another question. For example, Question A is a duplicate of Question B, so Question A is the source question marked as duplicate of Question B. ****Target question:**** A question that is the same question of another question and has answers or more information. For example, Question A is a duplicate of Question B, so Question B is the target question.

Limitations

- Only moderators can mark questions as duplicate.
- When the question is marked as duplicated, you see a label indicating that you can't engage with the question anymore: you can't add or edit the content.
- Duplicated questions don't show in the question list.

Mark question as duplicate

When a moderator marks a question as a duplicate of another, the source question displays a label directing users to the already answered target question.

1. Select the overflow menu on a question.
2. Select the button "Mark as duplicate".
3. A modal appears. Select the target question by entering into the text for the question title or the question title from the URL.
4. Confirm the action by selecting the blue "Yes, mark as duplicate" button within the modal.

Upon confirmation, the page refreshes, and the source question displays a duplicate label with a link to the target question.

Mark question as duplicate using question title

This option shows the most results and might not give you the question you're looking for.

Mark question as duplicate

Duplicate questions only allow limited engagement. The question will also display a "Duplicate" label and link to the target question. Select the target question below.

Question title *

Can NativeWindow be used for a window whose handle isn't exposed by a

Can NativeWindow be used for a window whose handle isn't exposed b...

Robert Gustafson asked Jan 18, 2023, 11:07 PM

How to handle nullreference exception in "NM_CUSTOMDRAW"...

Rashmi Gupta asked Jun 28, 2022, 5:23 AM

Mark question as duplicate using question title between double quotes

If you're using the question title, we recommend you add it between quotes for best results.

Mark question as duplicate

Duplicate questions only allow limited engagement. The question will also display a "Duplicate" label and link to the target question. Select the target question below.

Question title *

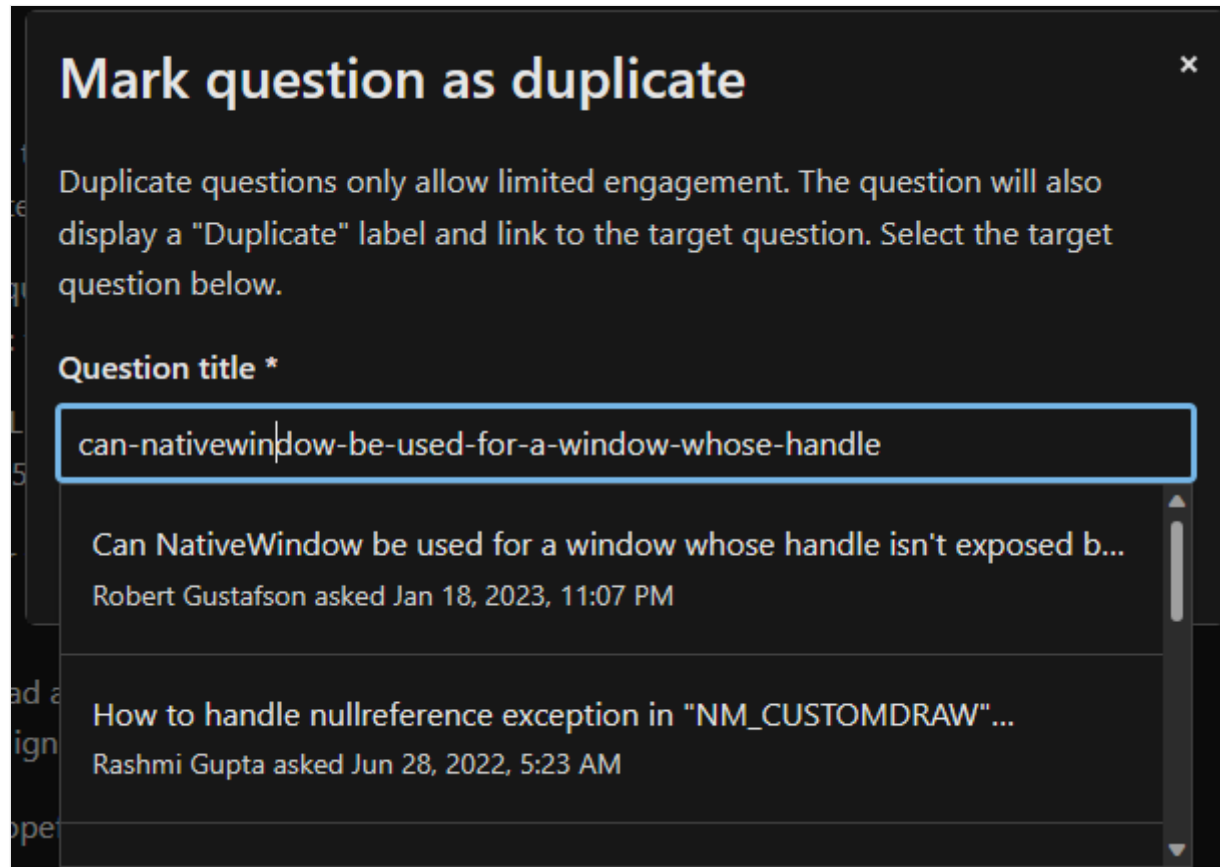
"Can NativeWindow be used for a window whose handle isn't exposed by a

Can NativeWindow be used for a window whose handle isn't exposed by ...

Robert Gustafson asked Jan 18, 2023, 11:07 PM

Mark question as duplicate using question title from the URL

You can find the target question using its title from the URL. This option shows few results. For example for question with URL `https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/answers/questions/1162236/can-nativewindow-be-used-for-a-window-whose-handle`, the question title is `can-nativewindow-be-used-for-a-window-whose-handle`.



Undo mark a question as duplicate

A moderator removes the duplicate mark to a question.

1. Select the overflow menu on the source question.
2. Select the button "Undo duplicate".
3. A modal appears. Confirm the action by selecting the blue "Yes, undo duplicate" button.

Upon confirmation, the page refreshes; the label is removed and you can engage on the question thread again.

Convert comments to answers and answers to comments on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 01/24/2025

Comments and answers serve different functions on Microsoft Q&A. Answers provide a solution to the question asked, whereas comments are more flexible and are used to clarify the question, add additional troubleshooting details, suggest ways to improve or narrow the question, etc.

When a comment is posted as an answer, it can mislead other users into thinking that a question has a posted solution when it doesn't. Additionally, when a user posts an answer as a comment, this content can easily be missed by people who are looking for answers (including the question author), and they cannot be marked as Accepted Answers.

To solve this issue, moderators and users can convert comments to answers and convert answers to comments.

Prerequisites

You need to be signed into Q&A.

Limitations

Unless you're a moderator, you can only convert your own comment or answer.

Convert comments to answers

If you have posted a comment which is a solution or prospective answer, convert the comment to an answer.

1. Select the overflow menu on any comment.
2. Select the button "Convert to answer".
3. Confirm the action in the modal pop up.

Upon confirmation, the page will automatically refresh, and the comment will now appear as an answer.

Convert answers to comments

When converting an answer to a comment, users must select the new location for the comment, whether as a comment on the question or a comment on a different answer. Upon confirmation, the answer and any comments on that answer will be moved to the selected location.

1. Select the overflow menu on any answer.
2. Select the button "Convert to comment".
3. Select the location to move the comment, under the question itself or another answer.
4. Confirm the action by selecting the blue "Convert" button.

Upon confirmation, the page will automatically refresh, and the answer and any of its comments will now appear as a comment in the selected location.

Delete content on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 01/24/2025

The [Q&A code of conduct](#) sets the standards for the site content. Moderators can delete content that doesn't meet these standards to maintain site quality and help users find answers quickly.

Important

Instead of deleting an answer that you think is unclear or incomplete, you can use a comment to request more details or clarification from the answer author. This way, we can show our appreciation for the users who share their knowledge and time with us. Another option is to share a different answer if you know one.

Prerequisites

- You need to be signed into Q&A.
- You need to be a moderator in Q&A.

Limitations

- You can't delete your own content. If you feel your content should be deleted, you can report it and a moderator can delete it.
- Deleted questions don't appear in the question or tag lists.
- If you aren't a moderator, you can't see any indication of a deleted answer or comment.

Delete a question

If you're a moderator, follow these steps to delete a question that doesn't follow [Q&A code of conduct](#).

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to delete.
2. From the question overflow menu (the ellipsis), select "Delete".
3. In the dialog box, confirm you want to delete the question thread.
4. Select a reason for deleting the content.
5. Select "Yes, delete content".
6. The full question thread is deleted.

7. You see a temporary message saying the content is deleted.

Delete an answer

If you're a moderator, follow these steps to delete an answer that doesn't follow [Q&A code of conduct](#).

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to delete one of its answers.
2. From the answer overflow menu (the ellipsis), select "Delete".
3. In the dialog box, confirm you want to delete the answer and all its comments, if any.
4. Select a reason for deleting the content.
5. Select "Yes, delete content".
6. The answer and its comments (if any) are deleted.
7. You see a temporary message saying the content is deleted.

Delete a comment

If you're a moderator, follow these steps to delete a question that doesn't follow [Q&A code of conduct](#).

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to delete one of the comments on the page.
2. From the comment overflow menu (the ellipsis), select "Delete".
3. In the dialog box, confirm you want to delete the comment.
4. Select a reason for deleting the content.
5. Select "Yes, delete content".
6. The comment is deleted.
7. You see a temporary message saying the content is deleted.

Seeing deleted content

Content authors can only see their deleted content. The question has a "Deleted" label on top. For other user's content, they see a standard message telling them the content is deleted.

Moderators can see any deleted content. Additionally, moderators can see the full list of deleted content by accessing the [Deleted tab in the moderation queue](#).

Escalate a question on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

As a Microsoft Q&A moderator, you have the ability to escalate a question thread. Escalating a thread draws the attention of the wider moderator community to offer support, provide answers, and help guide a question towards a quicker resolution.

Prerequisites

- You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).
- You need to be a moderator in Q&A.

Escalate a question

If you're a moderator, follow these steps to escalate a question thread:

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to escalate.
2. From the question overflow menu (the ellipsis), select "Escalate thread".
3. In the dialog box, provide a comment on why the thread is being escalated. This information will be available in the thread history.
4. Select "OK" to complete the escalation. The question has been added to the **Escalated** tab of the [Moderation queue](#).

Remove an escalation

If you're a moderator, and a question no longer needs to be escalated, follow these steps to remove the escalation:

1. From the escalated question, select the overflow menu (the ellipsis) and select "Remove escalation".
2. In the dialog box, provide a comment on why the thread escalation is being removed. This information will be available in the thread history.
3. Select "OK" to remove the escalation.

ⓘ Note

An escalation can also be removed by selecting "Remove escalation" on the question from the **Escalated** tab of the [Moderation queue](#).

Locking questions on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 04/10/2025

As a Microsoft Q&A moderator, you have the ability to lock and unlock a question thread. Some reasons to lock a thread include:

- **Pausing the conversation:** When the conversation starts to deviate from or not progress the original topic, locking the thread allows a moderator to intervene and [ask](#) for further details or clarification from the thread author.
- **The conversation has concluded:** When the original question has been resolved, locking the thread ensures that valuable information is preserved for future reference by other Q&A users.
- **Off-topic conversations:** When the conversation starts to include comments that are non-constructive or breach our [Code of Conduct](#).

When a thread is locked the following actions are possible:

 Expand table

| Action | Authenticated users | Moderators |
|------------------------------|---------------------|------------|
| Unlock question | No | Yes |
| Delete question | No | No |
| Make edits | No | No |
| Upvote question | Yes | Yes |
| Upvote/downvote answer | Yes | Yes |
| Upvote comment | Yes | Yes |
| Report | Yes | Yes |
| Add answer | No | No |
| Add comment | No | No |
| Initate private conversation | No | No |
| Follow | No | No |
| Mark as duplicate | No | No |

Prerequisites

- You need to be signed into Q&A.
- You need to be a moderator in Q&A

Lock a question

If you're a moderator, follow these steps to lock a question thread:

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to lock.
2. From the question overflow menu (the ellipsis), select "Lock thread".
3. In the dialog box, provide a comment on why the thread is being locked. This information will be available in the thread history.
4. Select "Confirm" to apply the lock. The full question thread is locked.

Unlock a question

If you're a moderator, follow these steps to unlock a question thread:

1. From a locked question thread, select the question overflow menu (the ellipsis) and select "Unlock thread".
2. In the dialog box, provide a comment on why the thread is being unlocked. This information will be available in the thread history.
3. Select "Confirm" to remove the lock. The full question thread is unlocked.

ⓘ Note

A migrated question lock can't be removed.

Locked migrated content

Content that has been migrated from the Microsoft Support Community ([Answers](#)), will be in a "locked" state. In this state, the following actions are possible:

 Expand table

| Action | Authenticated users | Moderators |
|-----------------|---------------------|------------|
| Unlock question | No | No |
| Delete question | No | Yes |
| Make edits | No | Yes |

| Action | Authenticated users | Moderators |
|-------------------------------|---------------------|------------|
| Upvote question | Yes | Yes |
| Upvote/downvote answer | Yes | Yes |
| Upvote comment | Yes | Yes |
| Report | Yes | Yes |
| Add answer | No | No |
| Add comment | No | No |
| Initiate private conversation | No | No |
| Follow | No | No |
| Mark as duplicate | No | Yes |

How do I know a question is locked?

A locked question will display a banner with details about the lock. The description will indicate whether the question is locked due to migration or moderator action.

A migrated question lock banner:

 Locked Question. This question was migrated from the Microsoft Support Community. You can vote on whether it's helpful, but you can't add comments or replies or follow the question. To protect privacy, user profiles for migrated questions are anonymized.

A moderator action lock banner:

 Locked Question. You can vote on whether it's helpful, but you can't add comments or replies or follow the question.

View thread history on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

As a Microsoft Q&A moderator, you now have the ability to view the activity history on a question thread. You are able to view:

- **Question creation:** Created by username and timestamp.
- **Edits and deletions:** Edited or deleted by username and timestamp.
- **Accepted answers:** Answer marked as accepted, with username and timestamp.
- **Reported abuse:** Part of the thread reported, with the username of the reporter, timestamp, and details of the report.

Prerequisites

- You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).
- You need to be a moderator in Q&A.

View history

To view the activity history on a question:

1. From the [Questions](#) page, select any question you would like to edit.
2. Select the overflow menu on a question.
3. Select "View thread history".
4. The thread history will populate at the top of the page.

Thread Histroy



Answer by Jane Doe accepted by OP

Jan 1, 2025, 4:00 PM



Question report addressed by John Smith

Jan 1, 2025, 2:00 PM

Reason: undefined



Answer edited by John Smith

Jan 1, 2025, 1:25 PM



Question undeleted by John Smith

Jan 1, 2025, 1:20PM



Question deleted by John Smith

Jan 1, 2025, 1:15 PM



Question reported by Art Vandelay

Jan 1, 2025, 1:15 PM

Reason: undefined



Question created by Mike Test

Jan 1, 2025, 12:00 PM

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Automatic translation on Microsoft Q&A



Summarize this article for me

As a Microsoft Q&A moderator, you have the ability to translate questions, answers, and comments between English and other languages. Also, when using this feature, responses provided in English will be translated back into the language used by the question author.

Prerequisites

- You must be signed into your [Microsoft Learn profile](#).
- You need to be a moderator in Q&A.

Limitations

- The base language is English.
- Only languages supported in Q&A will be translated. Refer to the list [here](#).
- On average, there is a 5 minute delay from when the question is created to when the translation is available. Some languages might take up to an hour for translation.

Using automatic translation

To use this feature, simply monitor the community as usual. When a user posts a question or comment in a non-English language, click on the translate icon to convert the entire question thread into English. When you or another expert responds in English, the response will be translated back into the language used by the question author. This ensures that all participants can understand and engage with the content, regardless of their language proficiency.

The screenshot shows a Microsoft Q&A interface. At the top right, there are icons for translation (two arrows), a plus sign, and a vertical ellipsis. The main heading is "nueva pregunta" in bold. Below it, a user profile for "Art Vandelay" is shown with a green circular avatar containing "AV" and a blue "Seguir" button. To the right of the profile, a translation menu is open, showing "Translate" at the top, "English (United States)" as the current selection, and "Español" with a checkmark. Below the menu, the text "r 2025, 12:30" is visible. The question text reads: "Ésta es una pregunta. Muestra la función de traducción automática." Below the question, there is a text input field containing the word "Azure". At the bottom, there are four action buttons: "0 comentarios" (with a speech bubble icon), "Notificar un problema" (with a flag icon), "Mensajes privados" (with an envelope icon), and "Tengo la misma pregunta" (with a plus icon in a circle). The "Tengo la misma pregunta" button has a small "0" next to it.

Experience feedback

If you have any feedback regarding your experience using auto translation, share it by utilizing the [Community Center/Discuss the Q&A site tag](#).

Last updated on 02/18/2026

Private messages on Microsoft Q&A

Article • 04/09/2024

Private messages on Q&A enable Microsoft moderators (support engineers employed by Microsoft,) to privately message question authors. The purpose of private messaging functionality is to allow Microsoft moderators to privately engage with question authors in scenarios where troubleshooting steps might contain PII (Personally identifiable information.) We never want users to post PII publicly on the platform, so private messages allow question authors and Microsoft moderators to exchange necessary information in a private, safe way!

Question authors – How to reply to a private message

From email notification

1. View email notification about new private message.
2. Click button to view and reply to private message.
3. Question thread with private messages modal opens on Microsoft Q&A.
4. Enter reply into rich-text editor.
5. Click "Send" button.

From question thread with private messages

1. Go to a question you asked that has a private message.
2. Open private messages modal – by clicking link in blue banner or private messages button.
3. Private messages modal opens
4. Enter reply into rich-text editor.
5. Click "Send" button.

Text editor

We use the same text editor for private messages that we use elsewhere on the Q&A platform! You can utilize the full rich-text editor while exchanging private messages, including attachment and draft autosave functionality.

New filters – View questions with private messages

There is a new filter available allowing users to filter by questions with private messages. This will be critical for Microsoft moderators to manage ongoing conversations with multiple users. NOTE: You must be signed into your Learn profile to use this filter.

Notification

Adjust your email preferences within Learn settings.

1. Click on "Settings" through the user menu.
2. Navigate to "Q&A preferences".
3. There is a setting called "Private message notifications."
4. Toggle on/off to enable/disable instant email notifications for private messages from Microsoft moderators.

Privacy

We take steps to protect any sensitive data! In compliance with privacy regulations, we delete all private messages in a conversation 30 days following the first message sent by a Microsoft moderator. We do not keep fragments of a conversations and delete message by message, and instead we delete the entire conversation after 30 days from the first message the Microsoft moderator sent to the question author.

Frequently asked questions

Who can view my private messages?

The questions author and any Microsoft moderators.

What is approved to be discussed in private messages?

This is not an exhaustive list of approved topics to discuss in private messages.

1. Email address
2. Support ticket ID
3. Logs, fiddler trace, and HAR files etc (where possible, please scrub any PII before uploading to minimize risk.)

4. Key vault keys information
5. Code snippets
6. Azure subscription ID or tenant ID
7. Teams meeting details, if needed to troubleshoot

Why can't I view a private message?

Sometimes, you may click "Reply" from an email notification about a private message, and the message won't open! This is because the private message(s) has been deleted. There are two potential reasons for this:

1. Microsoft moderator deleted their message.
2. 30-day private message retention period: All private messages in a conversation are deleted 30 days after the Microsoft moderator sends the first private message.

Can I edit my private message?

Yes, you can edit any of the private messages you have sent within the 30-day retention period.

1. Open private message modal from email notification, banner on question thread, or button on question thread.
2. Click the overflow menu for the message you would like to edit.
3. Make desired changes to the content.
4. Click "Save" button.

Can I delete my private message?

No; at this time, only Microsoft moderators can delete their own private messages. We eventually plan to support question authors deleting their own private messages.

What happens to my private messages if I delete my account?

If the question author involved in a private conversation deletes their account within the 30-day retention period, we immediately close and delete the conversation for all participants, instead of waiting until the 30 days to delete.

Leaderboards - Microsoft Azure Q&A Champions

The Microsoft Azure Q&A Champions Leaderboard recognizes Azure experts who consistently help customers by providing highquality, trusted answers on Microsoft Q&A.

This leaderboard highlights Champions with sustained contributions over a rolling 12month period, reinforcing the program’s focus on quality, consistency, and customer impact - not just volume.

How the leaderboard works:

- Includes Champions who have answered 60+ Azure Q&A threads in the past 12 months
- Updated monthly using a rolling 12month view
- Consideration of customer satisfaction (CSAT) where sufficient ratings exist

As Microsoft Q&A evolves toward AI-led answer experiences, Champions play a critical role as quality stewards, moderators, and governance partners, ensuring answers remain accurate, safe, and trustworthy at scale.

Learn more about the program and how to become a Champion: [Microsoft Azure Q&A Champions Program](#)

Sign up here: [Microsoft Q&A Champions Program – Azure](#) ↗

Top community contributors

 Expand table

| Q&A Display name | Azure Answers (last 12 months) |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Toby Phipps | 991 |
| Alex Burlachenko | 961 |
| Marcin Policht | 598 |
| Amira Bedhiafi | 530 |
| Sina Salam | 497 |
| Vinodh Kumar TD | 442 |

| Q&A Display name | Azure Answers (last 12 months) |
|---|--------------------------------|
| Andreas Baumgarten | 435 |
| Jerald Nicholas | 416 |
| Divyesh Goverdhanan | 350 |
| Abiola Akinbade | 322 |
| Michele Ariis | 271 |
| Nathan Roberts | 246 |
| Jose Benjamin Solis Nolasco | 230 |
| Sunoj Kumar | 220 |
| Suwarna S Kale | 191 |
| Deepanshu Katara | 156 |
| Andy David | 144 |
| Hossein Jalilian | 144 |
| Jimmy Salian | 140 |
| Vasil Michev | 140 |
| Mohamed Azarudeen | 139 |
| Obinna Ejidike | 128 |
| Shikha Ghildiyal | 118 |
| Nandan Hegde | 111 |
| Akpesiri Ogbebor | 95 |
| Luis Arias | 95 |
| Erland Sommarskog | 94 |
| Stanislav Zhelyazkov | 76 |
| Gowtham C P | 73 |
| Sander van de Velde | 65 |
| Ricky Brundritt | 61 |
| Chiugo Okpala | 60 |

Last updated on 03/26/2026

Microsoft Q&A Product Champions Leaderboard

This leaderboard recognizes the top [Product Champions Program](#) community contributors on Microsoft Q&A.

Notes:

- Only includes external community members participating in the Product Champions Program.
- Contributors are ranked in descending order by number of answers provided.
- Leaderboards are published monthly.
- Contributions are counted across the full calendar month.

Thank you to all Product Champions for your continued contributions and commitment to helping the Microsoft community succeed.

February 2026

All product tracks

1. [Stefan Blom](#)
2. [Dio Xavier](#)
3. [Thomas L](#)
4. [Hebikuzure aka Murachi Akira](#)
5. [Simo-k](#)
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7. [Splashcn](#)
8. [G225 - MVP 2009-2020](#)
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January 2026

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Last updated on 03/30/2026